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OPEN BY END-SEPT **P3**



RAHUL SAYS 'SYSTEM' DOESN'T WANT
STUDENTS TO ASK QUESTIONS **P5**

'DRISHYAM: THE CONCLUSION
AN ENTIRELY DIFFERENT STORY' **P12**

BILL TARGETS RUSSIAN OIL BUYERS, INCLUDING INDIA AND CHINA

Donald Trump's Russia Bill opens door to India tariffs

MPOST BUREAU/PTI
WASHINGTON, September 19

US President Donald Trump has signed the sweeping Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which seeks to impose steep levies on Moscow and its top energy buyers such as China and India.

"On Friday, September 18, 2026, the President signed into law: H.R. 5334, the "Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026," which authorizes and expands statutory sanctions, tariffs, and prohibitions on Russia and extends existing sanctions on Iran," the White House said.

The House of Representatives on Wednesday passed the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which seeks to impose sanctions on Russia's leadership and energy sector -- as well as



on collaborators in Moscow's defence industry and its so-called shadow fleet.

The Act also authorises President Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian oil and gas, including China and India.

The law gives Trump wide discretion over implementation, including which countries face tariffs, the tariff rates imposed, and whether sanctions provisions are waived.

The law comes into effect within 30 days of

signing by the President and requires him to impose duties of up to 100 per cent on goods imported from countries that are the top five purchasers of Russian crude oil or natural gas by total volume during the 12 months preceding enactment.

TARIFF THREAT

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A country is exempt from the gas-related duties if its Russian gas imports accounted for less than 15 per cent of Russia's total exports during the applicable period and it has taken "significant steps" to reduce those imports.

CONTINUED ON P4

DUSU polls: A 3-post sweep, & the independent who broke the script

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 19

The Delhi University Students' Union election threw up a result that was not entirely defined by the strength of the two major student organisations. While the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad retained three of the four central-panel posts, independent candidate Deepanshu Shokeen won the vice-president's post with a sizeable lead, after entering the contest without an organisational ticket.

ABVP's Yash Dabas was elected president with 24,576 votes, defeating NSUI's Vijay Shankar Meena, who polled 22,523 votes. The margin between the two was 2,053 votes. Riya Chhawdi won the secretary's post with 21,650 votes, while Lakshya Raj Singh secured the joint secretary's position with 16,615 votes.

It was the vice-president's race that departed most clearly from the overall pattern. Shokeen secured 30,615 votes, well



Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad's (ABVP) Yash Dabas, Riya Chhawdi and Lakshya Raj Singh celebrate with others as they climb atop Swami Vivekanand's statue after winning three of the four central panel posts

PTI

KEY POINTS

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- » Riya Chhawdi won the secretary's post with 21,650 votes, while Lakshya Raj Singh secured the joint secretary's position with 16,615 votes
- » It was the vice-president's race that departed most clearly from the overall pattern
- » Shokeen secured 30,615 votes, well ahead of ABVP's Ishu Maurya, who received 16,910 votes

ahead of ABVP's Ishu Maurya, who received 16,910 votes. NSUI's Virr Chatrath polled 4,313 votes. Shokeen's margin over Maurya was 13,705 votes.

For NSUI, the result meant a

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Odisha family loses 7 in MP drain tragedy

AGAR MALWA (MP)/BHU-BANESWAR: Eight people, including seven members of a family from Odisha, died after their car fell into a drain in Madhya Pradesh's Agar Malwa district early Saturday, officials said.

The eighth person was the car driver, who was a resident of Madhya Pradesh.

The accident occurred near the Bagulamukhi temple in Nalkhed town, around 30 km from the district headquarters. Nalkhed police station in-charge Shashi Upadhyay said.

He said that the car with devotees from Odisha fell into the drain, which was overflowing with rainwater, and

CONTINUED ON P4

Bittu detained over liquor bottle at CM cavalcade

LUDHIANA: Punjab Police detained BJP leader and former Union Minister Ravneet Singh Bittu on Saturday after he waved a liquor bottle, eggs and tomatoes as chief minister Bhagwant Mann's cavalcade passed on Ferozepur Road.

While holding the liquor bottle outside the Punjab Agricultural University, Bittu shouted that he was "returning the bottle" so that Mann could "enjoy his liquor while other AAP leaders loot Punjab".

The BJP leader also claimed he was returning the eggs and tomatoes that were hurled at his convoy near Batala in Punjab

CONTINUED ON P4

ChatGPT row ends in IIT-B student's death

Son tortured, killed, alleges mother

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, September 19

A 22-year-old student of Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay committed suicide in his hostel room after he was allegedly caught using his mobile phone during an examination, police said on Saturday.

Sahil Ravindra Wakode, a native of Maharashtra's Yavatmal district, was found hanging from the ceiling fan in his room in Hostel Number 4 on the Powai campus on Friday evening, an official said.

Wakode's mother alleged her son was tortured. "My son was killed, tortured. I want justice," she told reporters.

Wakode was a second-year B.Tech student in the Energy Science and Engineering department, he said.

According to a statement from IIT Bombay, the student had allegedly uploaded the examination question paper to ChatGPT to seek answers during the exam.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday said the government was working on multiple fronts to expand employment opportunities for the youth, citing Free Trade Agreements (FTAs), skilling initiatives and a Rs 1 lakh crore employment incentive scheme aimed at bringing two crore young people into the formal workforce.

Addressing a 'Rozgar Mela' (Jobs Fair) virtually, he said the talent and skills of India's youth have won the trust of the entire

TRAGEDY

» Wakode was a second-year B.Tech student in the Energy Science and Engineering department

» According to a statement from IIT Bombay, the student had allegedly uploaded the examination question paper to ChatGPT to seek answers during the exam

» The official said Wakode's death came to light after his hostel mates got no response from his room and alerted the authorities, who then informed the police

The official said Wakode's death came to light after his hostel mates got no response from his room and alerted the authorities, who then informed the police.

No suicide note was recovered from the spot, the official said, adding that the Powai police have registered an accidental death report (ADR) and sent the body for a post-mortem examination.

CONTINUED ON P4

Delhi Int'l Airport to reopen third runway for ops from September 20

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 19

Delhi International Airport on Saturday announced that it will reopen its third runway for operations from September 20, almost seven months after it was shut for major strengthening and work.

The comprehensive rehabilitation of Runway 11R/29L (commonly known as the third runway) is complete, and all necessary regulatory approvals are in place, paving the way for its recommissioning from September 20, private airport operator

DIAL said.

DIAL is a joint venture between infra major GMR group-led consortium and national airports operator, AAI.

The rehabilitation project, which started in February this year, involved extensive strengthening and upgrade works aimed at enhancing operational safety, efficiency, resilience, and long-term capacity at one of India's busiest aviation gateways, DIAL said.

Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport commissioned its third runway in 2008.

The upgraded runway is now ready for operational use after undergoing all required inspections, validations, and regulatory clearances, the airport operator said.

The rehabilitation programme involved completing major airside infrastructure enhancements, including runway resurfacing, permanent threshold displacement of runway 29L, construction of a new Rapid Exit Taxiway (RET Z1), upgrades to airfield ground lighting systems, pavement strengthening works, and associated

CONTINUED ON P4

Bengal bypolls: U-turn, arrest & custody mark twists

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, September 19

Amid withdrawals, arrests and uncertainty over electoral symbols, the October 6 bypoll continued to throw up fresh twists on Saturday, with the Mamata All India Trinamool Congress' (MAITMC) Rejinagar candidate reversing his decision to quit, an Independent candidate being

arrested and the Congress nominee in Nandigram being sent to judicial custody.

The Mamata faction continues to remain in the electoral fray after a dramatic U-turn by its Rejinagar candidate Rabiul Alam Chowdhury, who reversed his decision to withdraw within hours, a day after the faction's Nandigram nominee, Sanchita

Pradhan Dey, pulled out of the race after meeting Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari.

Meanwhile, Congress' Nandigram candidate Milan Pradhan was remanded in judicial custody till October 3 by the Haldia Subdivisional Court. Congress, however, said he would remain in the contest and had himself refused to withdraw

despite being behind bars. Pradhan was arrested on Friday-- soon after Mamata Banerjee pledged support to Congress after her party's candidate Sanchita Pradhan Dey withdrew from the contest -- on four pending non-bailable warrants in cases dating back to the 2007 anti-land acquisition movement in Nandigram. Police said the cases

involve charges including murder, attempt to murder, abduction with intent to murder, causing disappearance of evidence, house trespass and rioting with arms and deadly weapons. He has also been booked under relevant provisions of the Arms Act. A lawyer for Pradhan said he was remanded to judicial custody for 14 days in

CONTINUED ON P4

HANDS OUT 51,000+ APPOINTMENT LETTERS TO NEW RECRUITS FTAs opening new career avenues for youth: PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19



HIGHLIGHTS

- » 'India signed 40 Free Trade Agreements. These FTAs are opening new doors of possibilities for our youth'
- » Referring to the just-concluded BRICS Summit, Modi said India's effort has been to ensure that BRICS cooperation does not remain limited to governments alone
- » 'Our entrepreneurs, our farmers, our women, our youth - everyone should become an active partner in this partnership'
- » He said initiatives such as BRICS CONNECT and the BRICS MSME Cooperation Portal were aimed at bringing entrepreneurs, farmers, women and youth into such partnerships

world, which has great expectations from Indian innovators, entrepreneurs and the country's youthful

strength.

"India signed 40 Free Trade Agreements. These FTAs are opening new

doors of possibilities for our youth. Such trade agreements pave the way for new partnerships for

our entrepreneurs, open paths to new markets, and create new possibilities in careers

CONTINUED ON P4

Aadhaar check mandatory for LPG subsidy from Oct 1

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

Domestic LPG consumers will have to complete biometric Aadhaar authentication to book refills at the regulated retail selling price with applicable subsidy from October 1, the government said on Saturday, as it seeks to ensure subsidised cooking gas reaches only eligible households.

Consumers who have already completed the authentication will not need to take any further action. As of September 19, 27.43 crore active domestic LPG consum-

ers, or 89.9 per cent of the total, had completed biometric Aadhaar authentication, according to the Petroleum and Natural Gas Ministry.

For those yet to complete the process, subsidised refill booking will be enabled once authentication is completed, the ministry said in a statement.

The government said the measure is aimed at preventing diversion of subsidised domestic cylinders for commercial and industrial use, as well as eliminating duplicate and ineligible connections.

SEE P4

GLOBAL CEOs ARE NOW PREPARING TO INVEST

India's youth-driven talent will build next Qualcommms & Intels: Vaishnaw

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 19

With five semiconductor units in commercial production and global companies lining up fresh investments, the initial questions around India's chip strategy have given way to a growing vote of confidence, Electronics & IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Saturday, adding that he has full faith that youth-driven startups in India will build homegrown Qualcommms and Intels.

Vaishnaw said several countries view India as a trusted partner, but cautioned that the semiconductor industry and deeptech startups must remain vigilant against potential cyberattacks, threats and disruptions from those seeking to hinder India's rise in the global semiconductor value chain.

Over the past four to five years, global perception about India's manufacturing capabilities has undergone a fundamental shift, Vaishnaw said, noting that initial questions



Electronics & IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw

have dissolved into a vote of confidence as projects progressed from construction to pilot testing, and now full-scale commercial production.

Global CEOs are now preparing to invest, with many in the midst of finalising local partnerships and plant locations, Vaishnaw said, revealing that one chief executive had, in fact, told him during a conversation that his board had authorised him to commit as much capital for their India semiconductor plans as the team can possibly execute.

"So, that kind of response is validation of

our efforts, but I still say, this is just the first step... the foundation. A lot more has to be done because in an industry as difficult and as complex as the semiconductor industry, it is very important for us to have that perseverance, patience and meticulous follow-up," Vaishnaw said.

Emphasising that India's long-term success in semiconductors would depend on building differentiated products, not merely focusing on existing market solutions, Vaishnaw urged young innovators to showcase their design capabilities to compel manufacturers to adopt Indian

KEY POINTS

» 'Over the past four to five years, global perception about India's manufacturing capabilities has undergone a fundamental shift'

» 'Initial questions have dissolved into a vote of confidence as projects progressed from construction to pilot testing & full-scale commercial production'

supply chains.

The minister expressed confidence that youth-driven efforts will produce the next Qualcommms and Intels in coming years. "I am sure we will have Qualcommms and Intels coming from India in the coming years, as the younger generation takes over the responsibility of building good products," Vaishnaw said.

The minister's comments come as India has made an aggressive bid to build a flourishing semiconductor ecosystem, widening the focus beyond chip fabrication to equipment, materials, packaging, design and other critical

links in the supply chain.

Under the Rs 1,27,500-crore Semicon 2.0 policy push, India is deploying heavy capital incentives, flexing its engineering capabilities, and consumer market strength to create an end-to-end semiconductor value chain, from chip design to fabrication and testing to talent development.

According to the government, about \$11-12 billion of semiconductor investment interest has emerged under Semicon 2.0, with projects expected to materialise over the next two to three years.

The interest was reflected at the SEMICON India event - a mega showcase of the nation's chip-making prowess - that saw a slew of big-ticket announcements, including Applied Materials' \$5 billion India plan through 2035, Lam Research's proposed Rs 10,000-crore investment, Tata Electronics' 363-acre vendor park at Dholera and Fujifilm's Rs 800-crore semiconductor materials plant.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 19

The new US law empowering President Donald Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on Indian goods is a major concern as it is creating uncertainty over the otherwise healthy trade relations between the two countries, and such duties, if imposed, could severely disrupt India's exports to America, according to exporters.

However, the likely impact on Indian exports can be assessed only after Washington announces the tariff rate, product coverage and implementation schedule.

They added that the Russia-Ukraine war and West Asia crisis have already pushed up raw material prices and transportation costs.

Trump on September 18 signed the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which may impose steep levies on Moscow and its top energy buyers.

The Act authorises President Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian oil and gas, including China and India.

The law comes into effect within 30 days of

signing by the President and requires him to impose duties of up to 100 per cent on goods imported from countries that are the top five purchasers of Russian crude oil or natural gas by total volume during the 12 months preceding enactment.

"We are very worried and concerned. If the US imposes high tariffs, it will completely halt our exports to the US. No importer can afford this high level of tariffs," Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) President SC Ralhan said.

He said many engineering sector exporters have significant businesses in America and the US should factor in these aspects before taking any decision on new duties.

Sharing similar views, Mumbai-based exporter and CMD of Technocraft Industries Sharad Saraf said that more than tariffs, the uncertain environment impacts more.

"The clear impact can be assessed only after we have the details. We also have to see how much duty will be imposed on our competitor nations like China. We are quite worried about the new law because it is creating a lot of uncertainty in

the otherwise healthy trade relations. We are not able to take decisions," Saraf said. He said the move could be a pressure tactic on countries like India by the Trump administration ahead of the US midterm elections in November.

Import duty makes goods expensive in the importing country. Besides, a few other factors also play a role in this. For example, duties on India's competitor nations such as Bangladesh, Vietnam and Thailand, and the quality and standards of items.

Trade Promotion Council of India (TPCI) Chairman Mohit Singla said that the US move is a cause of "major worry" for Indian exporters.

"If imposed, it can severely impact certain sectors. It can create disruptions in the business relations of the two countries," Singla said.

Another exporter with major exposure to the US market said the American authorities should recognise that the world is a globally integrated village and that countries need each other.

He said any policy decision should ensure that the balance of trade is not disrupted.

NTPC terminates Mouda 400 MWh BESS contract over default

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 19

NTPC Ltd has terminated the contract awarded to M/s GR Infraprojects Limited (GRIL) for the 400-MWh Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) project at Mouda Super Thermal Power Station, Maharashtra, due to the contractor's failure to meet its contractual obligations and achieve the required progress.

The project, awarded in March 2026 at a total contract value of Rs 413.37 crore, is a strategically important BESS project and was scheduled for completion within 15 months in line with national energy objectives, however, the project witnessed significant delays in critical activities.

A contractual notice was issued to GRIL calling for immediate corrective action, but GRIL failed



to undertake the required remedial measures.

Accordingly, NTPC has terminated the contract with immediate effect and, in line with contractual provisions, has encashed available securities amounting to about Rs 91 crore.

The project remains a key initiative to strengthen grid flexibility and support renewable energy integration.

NTPC has already initiated action for re-tendering the project at the risk and cost of GRIL, in accordance with the applicable contractual provisions. NTPC is taking necessary measures to facilitate the early re-award and timely implementation of the project.

Shapoorji Pallonji Group backs Tata Sons listing, boosting board's push despite Trusts' opposition

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 19

Shapoorji Pallonji Group, the second-largest shareholder in Tata Sons, on Friday backed a public listing of the Tata Group holding company, saying it would strengthen transparency and public accountability.

Shapoor Mistry, chairman of Shapoorji Pallonji Group, which owns about 18.4 per cent of Tata Sons, said the listing was "not merely a financial or regulatory matter" but a "social and moral imperative". He said it could strengthen

governance while preserving the philanthropic role of Tata Trusts.

The Tata Sons board has favoured a listing after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) rejected the company's application to surrender its registration as an upper-layer non-banking financial company (NBFC).

Tata Trusts, which collectively control about 66 per cent of Tata Sons, have opposed the listing and urged the company to explore alternatives.

The Trusts have proposed providing liquidity to the SP Group through

a transaction of at least Rs 25,000 crore as an alternative to listing.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) rejected Tata Sons' application on September 11 to voluntarily surrender its registration as a core investment company and directed it to comply with regulations applicable to upper-layer non-banking financial company.

Tata Sons had sought deregistration in March 2024 after repaying Rs 21,813 crore of debt.

Tata Sons was classified as an upper-layer NBFC in 2022 and was required to

list by September 2025, but pursued deregistration instead.

Mistry said the Reserve Bank of India's decision provided "full clarity" and Tata Sons should move towards regulatory compliance.

He said a listing could broaden investor participation and provide a stronger basis for funding philanthropy.

The development comes amid differences over Chairman N Chandrababhan's tenure, with the board backing a further five-year term and Noel Tata opposing the move.

Railway Board Chairman reviews safety performance & operations

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, September 19

Railway Board Chairman and CEO Satish Kumar on Saturday chaired a high-



level review meeting with General Managers, Principal Heads of Departments and Divisional Railway Managers of zonal railways to assess safety performance and operational matters.

Kumar, along with Railway Board Members and senior officials, reviewed Eastern Railway's safety performance and progress of safety-critical works presented by General Manager Gitika Pandey.

The review covered strengthening safety

management, CCTV surveillance, elimination and interlocking of Level Crossing gates, modernisation of signalling systems and implementation of KAVACH, the indigenous Automatic Train Protection system, particularly on the Delhi-Howrah route.

Infrastructure and passenger amenity works, including track maintenance, Road Over Bridges and Road Under Bridges, and measures to address waterlogging at subways and Limited Height Subways, were also discussed.

Kumar emphasised sustained focus on safety, timely project completion and adoption of modern technology to strengthen railway operations.

EIL eyes Saudi, UAE oil infra projects to bypass Hormuz

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 19

State-run Engineers India Ltd (EIL) is in early-stage discussions with Saudi Arabia and the UAE to provide consultancy and engineering services for oil and gas infrastructure aimed at reducing dependence on the Strait of Hormuz, Chairman and Managing Director Atul Gupta said.

Saudi Arabia and the UAE are planning about \$1 billion of investments in pipelines, storage facilities, oil terminals and related infrastructure to create alternative routes for crude and petroleum products, Gupta said after EIL's AGM.

"They are at the planning stage and we are involved in discussions at the planning stage," he said, adding that EIL is seeking consultancy and feasibility-study mandates.

Gupta said the Iran conflict has disrupted shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, slowing order inflows from the region as energy producers focus on securing and restoring existing installations.

However, the disruption could create opportunities for EIL once the conflict eases.

"There has been a slowdown in order inflows from the region (in the aftermath of the conflict) but we hope to see the order inflow pick up in Q3 and Q4," he said.

Overseas projects account for 43 per cent of EIL's order book, while international consultancy contributed about Rs 4,929 crore, or nearly 62 per cent, of fresh business secured during 2025-26.

EIL secured fresh business worth Rs 7,978 crore in the year ended March 2026, taking its order book to Rs 15,109 crore as of March 31. The order book currently stands at around Rs 17,000 crore.

Manoj Kumar Sharma takes charge as Director (Projects) of GAIL



MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 19

Manoj Kumar Sharma on Saturday took charge as Director (Projects) of GAIL (India) Limited.

Prior to this, Sharma served as Executive Director and Regional Head, Eastern Region Pipelines, at Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL), overseeing operations, maintenance, construction and City Gas Distribution (CGD) businesses across five states and a pipeline network spanning more than 5,700 km.

A mechanical engineering postgraduate with a business management diploma, Sharma has over three decades of experience in hydrocarbon infrastructure, covering project management, procurement, construction and operations of oil, LPG and natural gas pipelines.

He earlier served as Executive Director (Projects), Pipelines Division, IOCL, handling major projects in India and overseas.

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OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER NATIONAL HIGHWAY DIVISION, RANCHI Din Dayal Nagar, Booty Road, Ranchi - 834008			
CORRIGENDUM OF TENDER			
This is to notify the concerned that the tender published in news paper by PR 388709 Road(26-27).D with Tender Reference Number- NH/RANCHI/SBD/2026-27/02 for the work " Construction of drain and culvert in between Km. 0.000 to Km. 39.100 of NH-143 AG under Special Repair (SR) under NH Division, Ranchi, Jharkhand for the year 2026-27 " has been revised. The amended schedule is as follows:			
S.No	Particulars	Published in Portal	As amended
1.	Start of submission of online bid	21.09.2026 upto 10.30 A.M.	30.09.2026 upto 10.30 A.M.
2.	End of submission of online bid	05.10.2026 upto 17.00 P.M.	14.10.2026 upto 17.00 P.M.
3.	Opening of Bid	07.10.2026 at 15.00 P.M.	16.10.2026 at 15.00 P.M.
Executive Engineer National Highway Division, Ranchi			
PR 390136 Road (26-27)_D			

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FROM NSUI TICKET SETBACK TO BAREFOOT CAMPAIGN, SHOKEEN WON BY 13,705 VOTES AS INDEPENDENT

How a bus conductor’s son became DUSU’s independent voice

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 19

For weeks, Deepanshu Shokeen walked barefoot across Delhi University’s campuses. On Saturday, he walked into the DUSU central panel as its newly elected vice-president, securing 30,615 votes as an independent candidate. The son of a Delhi Transport Corporation bus conductor and an Anganwadi worker from Peeragarhi village in west Delhi, Shokeen defeated ABVP’s Ishu Maurya, who polled 16,910 votes, by a margin of 13,705 votes. NSUI’s Virr Chatrath received 4,313 votes. Yet Shokeen’s journey

to the election was not supposed to begin as an independent. He had initially sought an NSUI ticket and, according to party officials, was nominated before being asked to withdraw. On September 11, he decided to contest independently, according to his father. The decision changed the course of his campaign. Without the backing of a major student organisation, Shokeen centred his campaign on issues he said he had experienced himself hostel facilities, university infrastructure and policies. “Whether it is the issue of hostel facility, university infrastructure or policies,

I have faced all of them myself,” he had said during the campaign. But it was his bare feet that became one of the most visible symbols of his campaign. After the September 6 Satya Niketan building tragedy, in which seven people, including five Delhi University students, died, Shokeen vowed not to wear shoes until justice was delivered to the affected students. Even on result day, he continued to walk barefoot near the counting centre. For his family, his political journey had taken a different turn from what they had imagined. His parents



“WHETHER IT IS THE ISSUE OF HOSTEL FACILITY, UNIVERSITY INFRASTRUCTURE OR POLICIES, I HAVE FACED ALL OF THEM MYSELF

had wanted him to prepare for the UPSC examination, but Shokeen chose student politics instead. He is currently pursuing a Master’s in Buddhist Studies after completing his graduation from Shaheed Bhagat Singh College. His parents said the victory was not merely about their son becoming a leader

but about every student who supported him. They thanked the students who stood by Shokeen and said he would continue raising student issues. Students supporting Shokeen also described the result as a “students’ victory”, saying his campaign demonstrated that an independent candidate could contest without the backing of a major organisation. Shokeen himself echoed that sentiment after the results. In an X post, he thanked Delhi University students and said the victory belonged to every student who wanted real issues to be raised on campus.

His election also leaves behind the dispute that pushed him into the independent contest. Shokeen had criticised organisational shortcomings within NSUI and questioned its candidate-selection process. An NSUI functionary, meanwhile, described his independent candidature as a challenge to the organisation’s ticket-distribution process. Now, the barefoot campaigner from Peeragarhi takes his place in the DUSU central panel, with a promise to raise the concerns of students who backed him and a campaign that began with a denied ticket and ended at the ballot box.

Minister Sood launches 100-day challenge offering ₹2 cr prize pool

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Saturday launched the Seva-First Innovation Challenge 2026 and said it aims to build a strong innovation and start-up ecosystem in Delhi, where young innovators can learn from successful entrepreneurs, start-up founders and industry leaders.

The 100-day initiative was launched at the Delhi Technical University (DTU), offering a Rs 2 crore prize pool, mentorship and government support to encourage young innovators to develop technology-driven solutions to real-world problems. With Delhi Technical University as the anchor university, the initiative will cover Haryana, Punjab, Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Chandigarh and Ladakh. Students from uni-

CLOSER LOOK

- » Addressing participants at DTU, Sood said the idea behind the challenge was simple — to serve society by finding solutions to real-world problems
- » The 100-day challenge will encourage students to work on agriculture, waste management, education and rural challenges

versities, industries, start-ups, schools, ITIs and polytechnics across these states and Union territories will participate, according to a statement. Addressing participants at DTU, Sood said the idea behind the challenge was simple — to serve society by finding solutions to real-world problems. The 100-day challenge will encourage students to work on agriculture, waste management, education and rural challenges. Participants will iden-

tify national and local issues, generate innovative ideas, develop prototypes, get them validated and work towards implementing practical solutions, Sood said. He said the initiative was not merely aimed at creating a few start-ups but at building a strong innovation ecosystem in Delhi, where young innovators can learn from successful entrepreneurs, start-up founders and industry leaders. The Delhi government

will provide necessary handholding and support, while promising ideas will be mentored and, wherever required, funding support will also be facilitated through the start-up ecosystem and policies, Sood said. Under the Delhi Start-up Policy, the goal is to create 10,000 start-ups and four lakh jobs in the national capital, he said, adding that the Seva-First Innovation Challenge was an important step towards creating an ecosystem where young people can turn their ideas into viable solutions and enterprises. The challenge carries a prize pool of Rs 2 crore and will provide young innovators a platform to bring forward their ideas, address real-world problems and develop solutions with social impact, the statement read. Sood said a Viksit Bharat by 2047 cannot remain merely a government ini-

tiative and must become a people’s movement. He said the programme draws inspiration from Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s governance model and his people-first approach. Highlighting India’s start-up journey, Sood claimed the country had fewer than 500 start-ups before 2014 and has now become the “world’s third-largest start-up hub”. “The transformation also reflected a psychological shift among young people, who were no longer only looking for jobs but were eager to create them through initiatives such as Start-up India and Digital India,” he said. The minister placed special emphasis on agricultural upliftment and rural engineering, praising DTU’s initiative to send engineering students to villages from the 2027-28 academic year to identify local challenges and develop practical technologies.



Barapullah Phase 3 to open by end-Sept

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

The much-awaited Barapullah Phase 3 is expected to be inaugurated by the end of September, PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Saturday. Singh mentioned that Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta will attend the inauguration on September 29. This project aims to provide seamless connectivity between East and South Delhi, linking Mayur Vihar Phase 1 and AIIMS via signal-free carriageways. The new flyover will merge with the existing Barapullah flyover at Sarai Kale Khan, completing a stretch of around 9 km. “The project is also set to become a landmark in urban infrastructure development. For the first time

in India, a flyover corridor has been designed with a dedicated cycle track, promoting greener and more sustainable mobility for Delhiites. Alongside faster vehicular movement, the project also includes pedestrian-friendly infrastructure and modern urban design elements,” the PWD minister said. Originally approved in 2014 and initiated in 2015, the project was initially scheduled for completion in 2017. However, it faced multiple delays and significant cost overruns, with the revised project cost now at approximately Rs 1,635 crore. According to officials, both ramps of the elevated corridor are complete — one ramp from the Mayur Vihar side and another continuing from the existing corridor near Sarai Kale Khan.

CM’S VOTE VALIDATED

Delhi SIR: Rekha Gupta, Kejriwal served notices for ‘discrepancies’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

Several prominent voters of Delhi, including Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and AAP supremo Arvind Kejriwal, have been issued notices by the poll body for “discrepancies” in the details of their enumeration forms submitted under the ongoing SIR exercise, officials said on Saturday. However, the entry for the chief minister has been “validated” and her name will be included in the final electoral roll of Shalimar Bagh constituency, scheduled to be published on

November 4, the CEO office said in a statement. It said the entry about Gupta was identified in the list of logical discrepancies based on details provided in the enumeration form. Each Delhi voter was required to submit completed forms during the door-to-door verification exercise from June 30 to August 17. It said that 33.13 lakh voters whose names were published in draft rolls will be sent notices for discrepancies in their enumeration form details. So far, 31.63 lakh voters have received the notices, it said in a statement. Most notices were

for missing records from previous special intensive revision (SIR) held in 2002. Gupta received the notice for an “age-related” mismatch, officials said. Former Delhi BJP president Virendra Sachdeva, Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal, and BJP leader Sudhanshu Mittal were also sent notices, they said. Kejriwal, a voter from the New Delhi Assembly constituency, has received the notice for being “unmapped with last SIR”. His spouse Sunita Kejriwal, parents and son have also been issued notices for the same reason.



Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar felicitates teams from Rohini and South-East districts for their exemplary performance at Police Headquarters on Saturday

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

A Delhi Police head constable and his wife were found dead inside their flat in outer north Delhi’s Narela on Saturday, with police saying the circumstances and sequence of events leading to the deaths were being investigated. The deceased were identified as Head Constable Monu, around 40, posted in the North District, and his wife Meenu, 35, police said. A PCR call was received around 1 pm regarding a flat that was locked from inside in the Narela area, following which police reached

the spot, they said. As the flat was locked from inside, entry was made with the assistance of the Fire Department, police said. The bodies of Monu and Meenu were found in the same room inside the flat, according to police. The couple’s two children were away from home at the time of the incident, according to preliminary information. They later returned and found the flat locked from inside. After their knocks went unanswered, neighbours gathered at the spot, sources said. The neighbours allegedly looked inside through a window and saw the

woman lying dead, while Monu was found hanging, according to the preliminary account. Police, however, did not confirm the sequence of events or the circumstances in which the couple died. The Forensic Science Laboratory team, Crime Team and senior police officers visited the spot and examined the premises, police said. The bodies have been shifted to Raja Harish Chandra Hospital for post-mortem examination. Police are probing all possible circumstances surrounding the deaths, including whether any dispute preceded the incident, sources said.

L-G hears grievances at Jan Sunwai in N-W Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Saturday heard grievances of residents during a Jan Sunwai organised at the Maurya Enclave police station in northwest Delhi, officials said. During the interaction, residents and complainants raised issues related to parking, traffic congestion, family disputes and matters concerning civic agencies, they said. Sandhu directed the concerned officers to examine the grievances promptly and take appropriate action as per law, officials said. The Jan Sunwai was

organised to provide citizens a platform to raise their concerns directly with the police and facilitate timely redressal, they said. The L-G also inspected the Maurya Enclave police station and reviewed its functioning and working arrangements. He interacted with police personnel and emphasised discipline, professionalism, prompt response to citizens’ concerns and a citizen-centric approach in public dealing, officials said. He also stressed the need to strengthen coordination and trust between the police and the public and ensure efficient delivery of police services, they added.

Delhi L-G Sandhu joins MCD cleanliness drive

Urges citizens to take ownership of neighbourhoods

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 19

Delhi Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Saturday joined MCD staff and young volunteers of the Vrikshit Foundation in a cleanliness drive at Durabh Nath Vatika in Shakurpur, urging residents to make cleanliness a shared responsibility. The drive was organised as part of the “Swachhata Hi Sewa Pakhwada”, being observed from September 17 to October 2 following directions from the LG Secretariat. MCD Commis-



sioner Sanjeev Khirwar, local councillors and civic officials were also present.

Sandhu interacted with volunteers and local residents and appreciated the participation of young people in cleaning the park through shramdaan. He said a cleaner Delhi required public participation and urged young residents to take ownership of their neighbourhoods. While sanitation remains the responsibility of the MCD, the LG said citizens must also recognise their role in keeping public spaces clean. He urged people to avoid littering and make cleanliness part of their daily routine.

House fire: Man found dead, posted suicide video before incident

New Delhi, September 19

A 64-year-old man was found dead in a fire-swept house in west Delhi’s Tilak Nagar on Saturday, police said, claiming it to be a case of suicide. The deceased, they said, shared a suicide note on WhatsApp before dying. Vijay, the deceased, had been living alone as a tenant in the Old Shahpura area for around five years, the police said. An incident of fire was reported at around 3.26 am on Saturday from the area. Four fire tenders put out the blaze. When the blaze was brought under control,

a severely burnt male body was found inside, the police said. The body was identified by Prakash Chauhan, a resident of Subhash Nagar, according to police. During the preliminary inquiry, the police found that Vijay had allegedly shared a WhatsApp message described as a suicide note and uploaded a video on YouTube in which he indicated that it was his last video. In the video, the man said he was taking his own life and that no one should be blamed for his decision. He also addressed his daughter, saying that he loved her and would miss her.

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ADDENDUM
ADMISSION UNDER VACANT SEATS
ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27

In continuation of the Admission Notice for Vacant Seats published in the newspaper on 19.09.2026, applications are hereby invited for admission against the vacant seat(s) in the following additional programme, as per the communication received from GGSIP University:

B.Com. (Hons.) - Vacant Seat - 01
Academic Batch: 2026-30

Eligibility & Reservation: As per GGSIP University / Govt. of NCT of Delhi Norms.

HOW TO APPLY
For Online Visit us at: www.meri.edu.in/meri OR Through Offline Form Available at Institute's Reception

LAST DATE OF SUBMISSION
September 23, 2026
For Further Details & Admission Schedule, Please Visit: www.meri.edu.in/meri

Note: This Addendum shall be read as an integral part of the Admission Notice for Vacant Seats published on 19.09.2026.

India's GDP will rise to \$38 trillion in 20 years: Doval

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Roorkee, September 19

National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval said on Saturday that India's GDP would increase from the current \$4.015 trillion to \$38 trillion in the next 20 years.

Addressing the convocation ceremony of the IIT Roorkee as the chief guest, Doval said that the students are fortunate to be living in a transformative era where their future holds great promise.

Citing the example of Lord Ram, the NSA urged students to be courageous in their lives. He said that sage Vishwamitra chose Lord Ram to annihilate demons because of his courageous nature. "Massive changes are taking place in India, and the country is moving towards a magnificent future," the NSA said.

"As the prime minister has termed the period leading up to 2047 as 'Amrit Kaal', it is truly a wonderful Amrit Kaal. India's current GDP stands at \$4.015 trillion, and it will reach \$38 trillion in the next 20 years," Doval added.

Doval also shared an anecdote from his early career days while posted in Sikkim, recounting how he learned three mantras for success in life from a Sherpa. Doval explained that the first mantra is knowing where one stands on the map; the second is knowing where one needs to go; and the third is knowing the path to get there and come back.

LPG SUBSIDY

Aadhaar biometric authentication mandatory for subsidised refills from Oct 1

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 19

Domestic LPG consumers will have to complete biometric Aadhaar authentication to book refills at the regulated retail selling price with applicable subsidy from October 1, the government said on Saturday, as it seeks to ensure subsidised cooking gas reaches only eligible households.

Consumers who have already completed the authentication will not need to take any further action. As of September 19, 27.43 crore active domestic LPG consumers, or 89.9 per cent of the total, had completed biometric Aadhaar authentication, according to the Petroleum and Natural Gas Ministry.

For those yet to complete the process, subsidised refill booking will be enabled once authentication is completed, the ministry said in a statement.

The government said the measure is aimed at preventing diversion of subsidised domestic cylinders for commercial and industrial use, as well as eliminating duplicate and ineligible connections.

Consumers can complete the authentication during LPG delivery, at their distributor's showroom or through the mobile applications of the three state-owned oil marketing companies - Indi-



A worker stacks up commercial LPG cylinders amid the ongoing supply crisis, in Thane

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Consumers who have already completed the authentication will not need to take any further action
- » For those yet to complete the process, subsidised refill booking will be enabled once authentication is completed, the ministry said in a statement

anOil ONE for Indane, HelloBPCL for Bharatgas and HP PAY for HP Gas.

Those unwilling or unable to complete biometric authentication will still be able to receive LPG, but at the applicable market price without subsidy.

Such consumers will

have to register their choice through the OMCs' digital channels, including websites, mobile apps, WhatsApp chatbots and IVRS. They can receive 5-kg or 10-kg cylinders, subject to local availability, it said.

The government had

initially asked consumers to complete biometric Aadhaar authentication by June 30, but subsequently extended the deadline several times to July 31, August 7, August 15, August 23, August 31, September 7 and finally September 14.

The nationwide authentication drive has been underway since October 2023, with oil marketing companies sending more than 12 crore SMS and WhatsApp messages and conducting outreach through distributors, delivery personnel, special camps, IVRS prompts and other channels.

The latest move comes against the backdrop of the government's substantial fiscal support for keeping domestic LPG affordable.

The implicit subsidy for a 14.2-kg cylinder was around Rs 210 in September 2026, compared to Rs 721 in June, according to the ministry.

The government paid public-sector oil marketing companies Rs 22,000 crore in compensation for domestic LPG under-recoveries in 2022-23 and is paying Rs 30,000 crore in each of 2025-26 and 2026-27, the ministry said.

RBI orders removal of Maha minister Babasaheb Patil

Seven others as directors of Latur District Central Cooperative Bank

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Latur, September 19

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has ordered removal of Maharashtra Cooperation minister Babasaheb Patil and seven other directors of the Latur District Central Cooperative Bank for exceeding the 10-year tenure limit.

Patil belongs to the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) led by Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar. Reacting to the development, he told news agency that he would not challenge the RBI's order, but the ten-year rule came into force in 2021 and it should be examined if it could be applied for appointments prior to that year.

The central bank's order followed directions passed by the Aurangabad bench of the Bombay High Court in response to a petition filed by bank member Satish Sheshrao Jadhav.

RBI Assistant General Manager Kapil Goswami issued the order on Friday.

Directors of District Central Cooperative Banks (DCCBs/Central Cooperative Banks) have a maximum tenure cap of ten years under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949, as amended by the Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025.

Earlier, State Coopera-

RBI ASSISTANT GENERAL MANAGER KAPIL GOSWAMI ISSUED THE ORDER ON FRIDAY

tion Department Deputy Secretary Sudhir Amrite had written to the Cooperation Commissioner, Pune, seeking action against directors of district central cooperative banks who had completed more than 10 years in office.

Subsequently, on May 25, 2026, Satish Jadhav submitted a complaint to the Chief General Manager of the RBI, seeking disqualification of eight directors of the Latur DCC Bank on the same ground.

Jadhav told news agency on Saturday that copies of the complaint were also submitted to the Divisional Joint Registrar, Cooperative Societies, Latur Division; the Cooperation Commissioner, and the NABARD section of the RBI.

As the RBI did not act on the complaint, Jadhav moved the Bombay High Court on June 21, 2026.

On August 3, the court asked the RBI to take action on Jadhav's May 25 complaint within six weeks.

From page 1

Donald Trump's...

The legislation targets Russia's "shadow fleet" and other foreign persons involved in supporting Russian energy production or sanctions evasion, including vessel owners, operators, managers, insurers, and other parties engaged in covered activities.

The bill targets Russia's economy by punishing major purchasers of its oil and gas.

At Trump's behest, the bill also extends to Iran's energy and weapons sectors.

The bill is named after the late Senator Lindsey Graham, one of Ukraine's staunchest defenders in Washington before his death on July 11.

The legislation seeks to reduce the financial resources sustaining Russia's war against Ukraine. It targets Russian officials, banks, energy interests, and foreign entities supporting Moscow's military operations. The law authorises Trump to impose tariffs on countries doing business with Russia to cut their dependence on Russian oil and gas.

According to the House Ways and Means Committee, the legislation directs tariffs of up to 500 per cent on Russian goods. It also provides for duties of up to 100 per cent on goods from countries covered by its Russian oil and gas purchase provisions - which cover major Russian energy importers and leading facilitators of oil sanctions evasion.

Additionally, the bill includes sanctions against Russian President Vladimir Putin and senior figures in the Russian government.

India is facing a new tariff threat now that Trump has signed the Russia sanctions bill into law.

An amendment introduced by Democratic Congressman Steny Hoyer had called for explicitly naming 10 nations - China, India, the UAE, Türkiye, Singapore, Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Hungary, Kyrgyzstan, and Slovakia - to be eligible for tariffs of up to 100 per cent under the bill's secondary tariff provisions. However, the amendment does not itself impose a 100 per cent duty on India.

The tariffs could be imposed on India if Trump chooses to exercise his power.

If Trump levies the 100 per cent tariff on India, it would be on top of a 10 per cent tariff that the US currently imposes on imports from New Delhi as a penalty for not doing enough to stop the import of goods made using forced labour.

However, the exact impact of new tariffs on Indian exports can be assessed only after the US announces the tariff rates.

India and the US had strained ties last year when Trump imposed an additional 25 per cent tariff on Indian imports of Russian crude, on top of a 25 per cent reciprocal tariff. The additional tariffs were, however, removed in February 2026, while the reciprocal tariff was reduced to 18 per cent as part of a US-India trade framework.

India on Wednesday made it clear that it is determined to take all necessary measures to protect its trade and economic interests.

"As stated on several earlier occasions, India remains firmly committed to ensuring energy security for its 1.4 billion people. It will continue to do so through diversified sourcing and based on evolving market dynamics," the Ministry of External Affairs said in a statement.

The MEA said the issue of India's oil trade with Russia has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various US interlocutors. "Its potential implications for not just the bilateral relationship but also the international energy market have been very clearly articulated by the Indian side," it said.

DUSU polls...

clean sweep of the central-panel posts by its opponents. The organisation had won the vice-president's position in 2025, while ABVP retained the president, secretary and joint secretary posts it had secured last year.

The election was held against a backdrop of concerns over student welfare, particularly hostel accommodation, campus infrastructure and safety. The Jantar Mantar student agitation and the Satya Niketan building collapse earlier this month also remained part of the political context around the polls. The collapse killed seven people, including five Delhi University students, according to the material provided for the election coverage.

Shokeen's campaign had acquired a distinct identity even before the results. He had initially sought an NSUI ticket but was later asked to withdraw, according to his campaign account. On deciding to contest independently, he built his campaign around issues such as hostel facilities, university infrastructure and student concerns.

His decision to campaign barefoot drew particular attention. After the Satya Niketan collapse, Shokeen said he would not wear shoes until justice was delivered to the affected students. He continued the campaign without footwear and was seen barefoot around the counting centre on Saturday as well.

Other candidates outside ABVP and NSUI also remained in contention. Samajwadi Chhattr Sabha candidate Vishesh Yadav polled 15,778 votes in the joint secretary's race, finishing behind ABVP's Lakshya Raj Singh.

The presidential contest had appeared to be moving in a different direction during the counting process. After four rounds, NSUI's Vijay Shankar Meena was leading the presidential race, while ABVP candidates held the advantage in the secretary and joint secretary contests. The final count put Dabas ahead.

The campaign itself had been marked by concerns over adherence to election guidelines. Campaign material was seen across parts of the university despite restrictions, while vehicles using loudspeakers and clashes between student groups remained among the issues that drew attention during the election period.

Security was tightened for the counting process, with police and paramilitary personnel deployed at strategic points. Foot patrols, motorcycle teams and PCR vans were stationed around university campuses and the counting venue, while movement around the area remained regulated.

NSUI National President Vinod Jakhar, reacting to the results, said the organisation would review its shortcomings and work towards returning to the electoral contest. He also alleged administrative interference and irregularities during the election. These allegations were part of NSUI's account of the election.

ABVP, meanwhile, attributed the outcome to student support for its organisational approach and highlighted student welfare, safety and campus facilities as areas of focus. Its newly elected representatives said they would work on student concerns and remain accessible to students.

ChatGPT row ends...

The incident also triggered protests on campus, with students demanding an inquiry into the circumstances surrounding the death.

The institute, in a statement issued late on Friday, said that the student was found using a mobile phone in the exam hall earlier that day.

But no disciplinary action was initiated against him, it stated.

The instructor and the Head of the Department had discussed the matter with the student and counselled him, assuring him the incident would not adversely affect his academic career.

He subsequently returned to his hostel room and was found dead later in the evening.

Delhi Int'l Airport...

civil and electrical infrastructure improvements, DIAL said.

Being the country's busiest airport, the facility handles over 1,300 flight movements (arrivals and departures) with four runways.

The airport can cater to 106 million passengers per annum.

The runway had been in continuous service for 17 years before the upgrade work began in February, though it underwent regular maintenance, including minor rehabilitation in 2017, according to DIAL.

These enhancements are expected to improve runway efficiency, optimise aircraft movement, reduce runway occupancy time, and further strengthen operational reliability.

Bengal bypolls...

connection with three warrants relating to Nandigram police station cases.

He will be produced before the Contai court on Monday in connection with the fourth warrant arising from a Khejuri police station case. The prosecution told the court that Pradhan had been absconding for 19 years.

Police said Pradhan had been chargesheeted as an absconder and repeated attempts to execute the warrants had failed. It said execution of long-pending non-bailable warrants was an Election Commission standing instruction during elections and bypolls, describing the arrest as part of an ongoing special drive.

Congress leaders turned Pradhan's arrest into a political flashpoint, alleging that the old cases were being revived to target the Opposition ahead of the October 6 poll.

Rahul Gandhi called the arrest a "murder of democracy" and alleged "political revenge" by the BJP.

AICC general secretary KC Venugopal alleged that Pradhan was pressured to withdraw, including with offers to drop cases and provide other facilities. He said Pradhan refused, telling party leaders: "Even if you kill me, I will not withdraw."

State Congress president Subhankar Sarkar questioned the timing, asking how police could arrest a candidate when the Model Code of Conduct was in force and the constituency was under the Election Commission. The Congress later held a rally in Kolkata against the arrest.

The BJP rejected the allegations, maintaining that the arrest was linked to pending criminal cases and warrants.

Meanwhile, independent Rejinagar candidate Saiful Islam, the AJUP's Nowda block president, was arrested by police on Saturday from Domkal in connection with an old case. He is scheduled to be produced in court on Sunday.

Odisha family...

the occupants, including three children and two women, died.

"Deeply saddened by the tragic loss of Odia tourists in an accident in Madhya Pradesh. My heartfelt condolences to the bereaved families. May the departed souls rest in peace," Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi said in a post on X.

The chief minister has directed officials to coordinate with the Madhya Pradesh government and local administration to expedite all procedures and ensure the mortal remains are brought back to Odisha with due dignity.

The deceased people were identified as Sibaprasad Behera (43), Rojalin Behera (34), Ritarani Behera (36), Gyanendra Behera (40), Sai Swarna Prava Behera (6), Krishna Rajbir (13), Sai Swastik Behera (10), officials said in Bhubaneswar. The identity of the driver is not yet known. AGENCIES

Bittu detained...

when he was en route to attend his party's anti-drug yatra in Pathankot on Friday. BJP president Nitin Nabin launched the anti-drug yatra.

Bittu alleged on Friday that AAP workers damaged his vehicles in the attack. "If

they throw eggs and tomatoes at us, we will return them. If AAP protests against BJP yatras, BJP will also protest democratically against the chief minister. We will not stay silent," Bittu said.

He said the BJP would hold peaceful protests outside the venues where the chief minister's programmes are held and that police action cannot silence political opposition.

The former Union minister claimed that over 100 AAP workers targeted his cavalcade and hurled stones and eggs at it.

"A window pane of two escort vehicles broke. They also damaged the jammer vehicle," Bittu had alleged. MPOST

FTAs opening...

for our youth," Modi said.

He distributed more than 51,000 appointment letters virtually to newly selected youth, who will join various government departments and organisations.

Referring to the just-concluded BRICS Summit, Modi said India's effort has been to ensure that BRICS cooperation does not remain limited to governments alone.

"Our entrepreneurs, our farmers, our women, our youth - everyone should become an active partner in this partnership," he said. He said initiatives such as BRICS CONNECT and the BRICS MSME Cooperation Portal were aimed at bringing entrepreneurs, farmers, women and youth into such partnerships.

Referring to the country's startup ecosystem, the prime minister said India's youth power is reflected in it and the startup ecosystem is no longer limited to big cities but has expanded to smaller cities as well.

"India is today the world's third-largest startup ecosystem. And India's startup story is no longer just the story of big cities. Today, nearly half of recognised startups are in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities," he said.

Modi also highlighted the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rojgar Yojana, a Rs 1 lakh crore initiative aimed at bringing two crore youth into the formal workforce for the first time.

He said the scheme provides incentives of up to Rs 15,000 to first-time employees while also financially incentivising employers who create new jobs. "The government is working on every front to increase employment in the country," he said.

Modi also highlighted the government's skilling initiatives, including the National Education Policy, Skill India Mission and Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana.

He said 1,000 government Industrial Training Institutes are being modernised under the PM-SETU scheme with an investment of Rs 60,000 crore and participation from industry. He cited a 7.8 per cent economic growth rate and a nearly 12 per cent rise in investments during the first quarter, and underlined upgrades to India's sovereign credit ratings amid global uncertainties. WITH AGENCY REPORTS

‘Startup center made to turn youth’s ideas into reality’

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, September 19

Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Saturday said that his government is creating a strong framework of suitable opportunities, financial assistance and institutional support to give flight to the dreams of the youth of the state so that their innovative ideas can be converted into reality.

Attending the ISB Leadership Summit-2026 organised by the Indian School of Business (ISB) at the Mohali campus on the theme ‘India Unbound: Defining Tomorrow’s Leadership’ as the chief guest, Chief Minister Mann said that there is no dearth of talent or energy among the youth of Punjab. That is why the government is focusing on providing a suitable platform to such bright minds to showcase their talents, set up businesses and generate employment.

He said that the government has established a ‘Startup Center’ to turn innovative ideas into reality. While under the ‘Business Blasters’ programme, students have been provided with seed money and constructive and useful ideas from the School of Eminence so that they can take a leap towards a bright future.

Calling on industrialists and investors to invest in Punjab, he said that the state is being developed as a hub of industry, investment and innovation.

‘DEVELOPED NATIONS’ CARBON EMISSIONS 6 TIMES MORE’

PM flags climate inequality

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 19

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday said that developed nations produce six times more per capita carbon emissions than India, yet developing countries are often unfairly blamed for climate change.

Inaugurating an international conference on environment and climate, the Prime Minister also said that the country is working at a fast pace on nuclear energy generation.

But, he said, whenever he takes forward work on nuclear energy generation, those who preach most loudly about the environment actively oppose clean energy solutions by filing court cases to halt the government’s nuclear initiatives.

“We all know that the responsibility for carbon emissions has often been wrongly placed on developing countries. While the historical truth is that even today, India’s contribution to per capita carbon emissions is less than half of the global average,” he said at the two-day event being attended by environmental experts, Supreme Court judges, legal experts and senior government officials.

Modi said developed nations have six times more per capita carbon emissions compared to India and New Delhi strongly presents this fact on global platforms. “And I would say to every Indian:



PM Narendra Modi addresses the inauguration of the International Conference on The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics, in New Delhi

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Prime Minister also said that the country is working at a fast pace on nuclear energy generation
- » Modi said India is working with the rest of the world and is setting new standards for environmental protection

You too say this forcefully,” he said.

The Prime Minister said India is working with the rest of the world and is setting new standards for environmental protection. He asserted that “our development is both speedy, as well as sustainable”.

The prime minister said that India is focusing on renewable energy and is the only nation in G20 that has already fulfilled its Paris (COP 21) commitments, well before its

timeline.

“This is the power of New India. Non-fossil fuels, solar energy capacity, stoppage on carbon emissions... India’s performance on all such metrics is being discussed across the world,” he said.

Modi said in the last 12 years, the country’s wind energy capacity has gone up three times and the hydro energy capacity has also seen a jump and now the country is working at a fast pace on nuclear

energy generation.

“And people who give big lectures on environment, when I take forward the nuclear energy work, they will go to courts to stop it,” he said.

The prime minister said the government is also opening pathways to bring in private players in these sectors.

“With these efforts, India’s non-fossil energy capacity has grown by 400 per cent,” he said.

The prime minister said that over the past 12 years, India has made extraordinary progress in every field connected to the environment, in every sector.

“Our major focus has been on renewable energy, and this has played a significant role in environmental protection,” he said.

Rahul says ‘system’ doesn’t want students to ask questions

Targets ‘Andhbhakt’ at Chhatron ki Goonj event

OUR CORRESPONDENT Indore, September 19

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday alleged that the “system” has captured the entire country and it does not want students to raise questions.

Speaking at his youth outreach programme ‘Chhatron ki Goonj’ at Indore in BJP-ruled Madhya Pradesh, he said only students can remove hatred from the country and not the “Andhbhakt”, referring to the supporters of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the BJP.

Students from various parts of Madhya Pradesh raised their issues at the event, including the freeze on 13 per cent recruitment in government posts owing to legal cases over the hike in the OBC quota.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said students are the future of India, and without them no country can become



Congress MP Rahul Gandhi addresses the ‘Chhatron ki Goonj’ event, in Indore on Saturday

strong. Students are asking questions about the “system, including “Adani, Ambani, Jay Shah” and others, but “Andhbhakt oppose them”, he said.

The students embody curiosity, love, humility, tolerance and honesty, while an Andhbhakt lacks all these virtues and spreads hatred, he added.

“Ten lakh posts of teachers are vacant in the country. One lakh schools, including 55 per cent in UP and MP, have been

closed,” he claimed.

The UPA government had allocated 4.6 per cent of the Budget to education in 2014, while now the allocation has plummeted to 2.6 per cent or Rs 7.7 lakh crore, Gandhi said.

Gandhi also targeted PM Modi, Union Home minister Amit Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and industrialists Mukesh Ambani and Gautam Adani, accusing them of ruining the system.

Hooda attacks BJP over development

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, September 19

Former Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda stated that the Congress government made Haryana the country’s number one state in terms of per capita income, per capita investment, job creation, government employment, honoring sportspersons, ensuring fair crop prices for farmers, respect-

ing the elderly, women’s safety, and law and order between 2005 and 2014.

However, in the last 12 years, the BJP has turned the state into the number one state for unemployment, crime, drug abuse, corruption, and debt.

He noted that from the state’s formation in 1966 until 2014, the total debt stood at approximately Rs 70,000 crore; under the BJP government, this figure has surged to Rs 5.50

lakh crore. During this period, the BJP government did not extend the metro line by even an inch, lay new railway tracks, establish major projects, build medical colleges, or open significant educational institutions.

“The question arises, into whose pockets did these lakhs of crores of Rupees go? The answer lies in the scams that are being exposed daily under the BJP govt,” he stated.

Mamata moves SC against Election Commission decision to freeze party’s name and symbol

OUR CORRESPONDENT Kolkata, September 19

Mamata Banerjee has moved the Supreme Court challenging the Election Commission’s interim freeze on the Trinamool Congress’s name and its traditional flowers-and-grass symbol, while the poll panel has assigned new symbols to Naushad Siddiqui’s Indian Secular Front (ISF) and Humayun Kabir’s Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) ahead of the October 6 bypolls in Nandigram and Rejinagar.

The Commission on Friday allotted separate names and symbols to the two rival factions claiming the Trinamool identity. The faction led by Banerjee was given the name ‘Mamata All India Trinamool Congress’ and the football player symbol.

The rival faction led by Ritabrata Banerjee was allotted ‘Democratic Trinamool Congress’ and the



Mamata Banerjee

envelope symbol.

The interim arrangement follows the Commission’s decision to bar both groups from using the ‘All India Trinamool Congress’ name and the reserved flowers-and-grass symbol until the dispute is substantively decided under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968.

Banerjee has challenged the order before the Supreme Court, making the ECI and Ritabrata Banerjee respondents.

Meanwhile, for the Rejinagar bypoll, the Commission has now allotted ISF the cupboard symbol. Nau-

KEY POINTS

- » The faction led by Banerjee was given the name ‘Mamata All India Trinamool Congress’ and the football player symbol
- » The rival faction led by Ritabrata Banerjee was allotted ‘Democratic Trinamool Congress’ and the envelope symbol
- » Meanwhile, for the Rejinagar bypoll, the Commission has now allotted ISF the cupboard symbol

shad has written to the poll panel seeking restoration of the envelope symbol and said he would approach the Calcutta High Court.

The allocation of the envelope symbol to the Ritabrata faction of Trinamool Congress had prompted Naushad to protest.

The ISF has used the symbol since its electoral debut in 2021, when the party contested the Bhangar seat and Naushad emerged as its sole MLA as part of the Sanjukta Morcha. He retained Bhangar in the 2026 Assembly election.

The party had originally

used the envelope after borrowing it from Bihar’s Rashtriya Secular Majlis Party, as it had not been allotted a symbol before the 2021 election. Despite subsequently applying for a permanent symbol, ISF continued to contest elections with the envelope.

Kabir’s AJUP has similarly lost the whistle symbol it used in the 2026 Assembly election and has been allotted a table for the Rejinagar contest. Kabir had won both Rejinagar and Nowda in the Assembly election but vacated Rejinagar, where his son Gholam Nabi Azad is now contesting.

India needs tech-led mining sector: Jitendra

AAISHA SABIR New Delhi, September 19

India must move from a resource advantage to technology-driven competitiveness in mining and metals, with technology integrated across the entire value chain from geological exploration and mining to processing, logistics, recycling and downstream manufacturing, Union Minister of State (I/C) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences Jitendra Singh said while speaking to **Millennium Post**.

The minister said the sector was entering a

defining phase as the country moves towards Viksit Bharat 2047, with a central role in infrastructure, energy transition, manufacturing and self-reliance.

Digital technologies could bring together geological, operational, energy, logistics and market data to enable faster decision-making, he said, while process technologies could unlock low-grade ores and residues and support lower-carbon metal-making.

“Our ambition should be to develop, demonstrate and scale technologies in India, for India and for the world,” he said.

‘Haryana making India self-reliant in foodgrains’

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, September 19

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini thanked Union Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman, for organising the two-day conference on ‘Financing India’s Journey Towards Viksit Bharat’ at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.

He said that such conferences are extremely important for realising Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of Viksit Bharat-2047 and that farmers have a crucial role to play in this journey.

The Chief Minister said that Haryana, being an agrarian state, has made

a significant contribution to filling the country’s foodgrain reserves and making India self-reliant in foodgrains. During the conference, he sought an “Integrated Natural Farming and Water Security Funding Package” for Haryana.

Addressing the media after the conference, CM Saini said that meaningful discussions were held on further strengthening the economies of the states and the country and achieving the goals of Viksit Bharat. Detailed deliberations were also held on future plans to further strengthen the agriculture and energy sectors.

Name Change	Name Change
I, Rajesh Bhati S/o Bir Singh R/o H.No. 230, Sector-19, Faridabad , Haryana,do hereby solemnly affirm & declare. That I have changed my name Rajesh Kumar to Rajesh Bhati. That in future I will be called by the name of Rajesh Bhati for all the purpose. That both the names are of the same person.	I, Shashi Bhati W/o Rajesh Bhati R/o H.No. 230, Sector-19, Faridabad , Haryana,do hereby solemnly affirm & declare. That I have changed my name Shashi Bala Singh to Shashi Bhati. That in future I will be called by the name of Shashi Bhati for all the purpose. That both the names are of the same person.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/
84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Mirza Sadiq Beg @ Sajid S/o Mirza Atiq Beg R/o H.No. A-9/4, Gali No.9, Gurudwara Mohalla, Maujpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.102/2018 U/s 354B/323/506/509/34 IPC at PS: Jafraabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mirza Sadiq Beg @ Sajid** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mirza Sadiq Beg @ Sajid** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant), Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mirza Sadiq Beg @ Sajid of FIR No. 102/2018 U/s 354B/323/506/509/34 IPC of PS: Jafraabad, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 31.10.2026.**

By order
Pooja Suhag
Judicial Magistrate First Class Mahila Court-03
Room No.08, 2nd Floor
Shahdara District,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12248/NE/2026

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय
पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर

लापता: आवश्यक सूचना

गुमशुदा विवेक कुमार सिंह, उम्र-करीब 41 वर्ष

सर्व साधारण को सूचित करना है कि गुमशुदा विवेक कुमार, उम्र-करीब 41 वर्ष, पिता- राजेन्द्र प्रसाद सिंह, पता-गोरख-39, हयूम पार्क एरिया, नियर सिविल कोर्ट, थाना-सीतारामदेरा, जिला-पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर जो दिनांक-18.03.2026 को घर से बिना बताये कहीं चला गया है लेकिन अभी तक वापस नहीं लौटा है। गुमशुदा करीब 20 वर्षों से मानसिक रूप से अस्वस्थ है। आवेदक एवं इनके परिवार वालों ने अपने स्तर से काफी खोजबीन किया परन्तु कुछ पता नहीं चल सका। गुमशुदा बालक का इस्त्रिया निम्न प्रकार है :-उम्र-करीब 41 वर्ष, कद-05 फीट, रंग-सौंवला, पहनावा-काला बैट, हाफ चैक शर्ट, पैर में चप्पल एवं माथा-हिन्दी।

अतः आप सभी जन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि उपरोक्त गुमशुदा के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती है तो इसकी सूचना वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर
पुलिस अधीक्षक (नगरी), पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर
सहायक पुलिस अधीक्षक, (गु-01)
थाना प्रभारी, सीतारामदेरा

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वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर

PR 390107 Police(26-27).D

POLICE HELPLINE (EMERGENCY DIAL)-112 CHILD HELPLINE-1098
WOMEN HELPLINE-1091 DOMESTIC ABUSE HELPLINE-181
CYBER CRIME HELPLINE-1930 AMBULANCE SERVICE-108

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that our client is investigating the rights, title, interest and entitlements of M/s Narsi Iron & Steel, a partnership firm, acting through its constituent partners, and/or its successor(s) and persons claiming through or under it (collectively, the ‘Claimants’), in relation to the immovable properties situated in Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, more particularly described in the Schedule below (‘Scheduled Properties’), as part of the legal and title due diligence for a proposed hospitality project.

The documents made available record that, under the Partnership Deed dated 7 February 1994, effective from 1 February 1994, the partners of M/s Narsi Iron & Steel contributed their respective land and buildings to the partnership firm as capital contributions. The said Partnership Deed records that the Scheduled Properties would constitute assets of, belong to and vest in the partnership firm, free from encumbrances, and that the agreed value of each property would be credited to the capital account of the respective contributing partner.

Any person, firm, company, financial institution, governmental authority or other entity having any right, title, claim, demand, objection, interest or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in or over the Scheduled Properties or any part thereof, including by way of ownership, sale, agreement, allotment, partnership right, capital contribution, succession or conversion of the partnership firm, transfer or vesting in any successor entity, retirement or dissolution of partnership, lease, licence, mortgage, charge, lien, development right, possession, easement, inheritance, family settlement, court order, decree, injunction, arbitration, acquisition or otherwise, is hereby called upon to notify the undersigned in writing, together with supporting documents, at the address and email stated below within 6 (Six) days from the date of publication of this notice.

If no claim or objection is received within the aforesaid period, our client shall proceed on the basis that no person has any subsisting adverse claim, right, title, interest, objection or encumbrance in relation to the Scheduled Properties, and any claim not so notified shall be treated as waived and shall not be binding upon our client.

SCHEDULE

DESCRIPTION OF THE SCHEDULED PROPERTIES

All the following immovable properties situated in Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, stated to have been contributed to M/s Narsi Iron & Steel under the Partnership Deed dated 7 February 1994:

- Properties contributed by Shri Devi Das Garg: (a) Leasehold land comprising Plot No. S/1, situated at Industrial Area, Site-A, Mathura, admeasuring approximately 4,674 square metres; and (b) freehold land comprised in Khasra Nos. 63/1, 63/2, 63/A and 63/B, admeasuring approximately 8.77 acres, together with the structures standing thereon.
- Property contributed by Shri Rajendra Kumar Garg, as Karta of Rajendra Kumar HUF: Freehold land comprised in Khasra Nos. 95 and 96, admeasuring approximately 5.04 acres.
- Property contributed by Shri Rajendra Prasad: Freehold land comprised in Khasra Nos. 50, 51 and 52, admeasuring approximately 2.84 acres.
- Property contributed by Shri Rajendra Kumar Agarwal: Freehold land and building forming part of Plot No. 1981/2, Dampier Nagar, Mathura, admeasuring approximately 1,364.84 square metres.
- Property contributed by Shri Pramil Kumar: Freehold land comprised in Khasra Nos. 74 and 95, admeasuring approximately 8.63 acres.
- Property contributed by Shri Dal Chand: Freehold land comprised in Khasra Nos. 45 and 49, admeasuring approximately 6.22 acres.
- Property contributed by Smt. Amita Garg: Freehold land and building forming part of Plot No. 1981/2, Dampier Nagar, Mathura, admeasuring approximately 348 square metres.
- Property contributed by Shri Santosh Kumar Garg: Freehold land and building forming part of Plot No. 1981/2, Dampier Nagar, Mathura, admeasuring approximately 348 square metres.

Together with all buildings, structures, constructions, pathways, passages, easements and other rights and appurtenances attached or appurtenant to the aforesaid properties.

Iqbal Tahir, Advocate
Bar Council Enrolment No. JK/52/2007
Dua Associates, Advocates and Solicitors
704-705, Global Business Park, Tower B, Mehrauli-Gurgaon Road, Gurugram 122002 Email: iqbal.tahir@duaassociates.com

News at a glance

As Europe warms, Italy sees West Nile virus spread

ROME: Italian health authorities see evidence that rising temperatures and longer warm seasons are helping mosquitoes spread West Nile virus across a wider area, during more months of the year.

More than 650 infections have been reported in Italy so far this year, according to local health authorities. "Higher temperatures linked to climate change help mosquitoes reproduce and extend the transmission season, increasing the chances that infected mosquitoes will spread the virus to people," said Antonino Bella, researcher at Italy's National Institute of Health.

President Herzog lauds Israeli Ahmadiyya Muslims

HAIFA: Israeli President Isaac Herzog lauded the Ahmadiyya Muslims as an embodiment of "shared life, tolerance and respect" at the community's annual convention in Haifa, attended by prominent religious leaders of different faiths, academics and public figures.

The community's 29th annual conference or 'Jalsa Salana', held this week in Haifa, examined the historic Constitution of Medina and the principles it may offer for reflecting on shared citizenship, relations between diverse communities, mutual responsibility and the role of religion in building peace.

'SL police to seek Interpol blue alert for Basil Rajapaksa'

COLOMBO: Sri Lanka police will soon request an Interpol blue alert for former minister Basil Rajapaksa, wanted on money laundering charges and misappropriating state funds for electioneering, the island nation's police chief said on Saturday.

Basil is the younger brother of former president Mahinda Rajapaksa and was his powerful economic development minister from 2010 to 2015. He later became the finance minister under the presidency of the other sibling, Gotabaya Rajapaksa, from 2019 to 2022.



People protest outside the Kennedy Center over the threats by President Trump to demolish the performing arts center, in Washington

AP/ PTI

US has all control over Greenland security: Trump

AGENCIES
Washington, September 19

Over a year since US President Donald Trump began his second term and revived threats of an American takeover of Greenland, the US and Denmark on Friday announced a deal on Greenland's security.

Greenland is a self-governing territory within the Kingdom of Denmark. Under the 2009 Self-Government Act, its government exercises wide legislative and executive powers, while Greenlanders retain the right to determine the island's future.

While Trump said the agreement, which will be signed next week, will grant the US "permanent control over security, and all other needs", Denmark offered a narrower description.

Denmark's Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen said the deal strengthens security in the Arctic and the North Atlantic area.

AHEAD OF TRUMP-XI SUMMIT
Top US and China negotiators to hold final preparatory talks

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Beijing, September 19

Top US and Chinese negotiators will hold final preparatory talks in Washington from Saturday, including on tariffs, ahead of President Xi Jinping's expected visit to the United States for a summit with his counterpart Donald Trump, the commerce ministry here said.

Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng will lead a delegation to Washington from September 19 to 23, where the two sides will discuss economic and trade issues of mutual concern, guided by the consensus reached by Xi and Trump, the ministry said.

The talks come ahead of Xi's expected visit to Washington next week. Although Beijing is yet to officially announce the trip,



US President Donald Trump with China's President Xi Jinping

AP/FILE PIC

US media reports have said that Xi is expected to arrive on September 23 and meet Trump the following day.

Trump plans to accord a rare airport reception to Xi by personally receiving him on the tarmac at Joint Base Andrews when the Chinese President arrives, the Hong Kong-based South China Morning Post

reported earlier.

The two leaders last met in Beijing in May during Trump's visit, when they held talks aimed at improving ties between the world's two largest economies.

Vice Premier He is set to hold talks with the US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent on a wide range of issues, including tariffs and artificial intelligence.

Bessent confirmed the talks, saying he looked forward to meeting Vice Premier He and continuing their "very good private discussions".

The talks assume significance in the immediate backdrop of Trump signing a new sanctions bill to impose 100 per cent tariffs on countries buying Russian oil and gas, including China and India.

Trump renews USD 100,000 fee on H-1B visas, tightens scrutiny
Indians remain single largest beneficiary group of US H-1B visa

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, September 19

US President Donald Trump has extended by a year the USD 100,000 fee on employers for bringing in foreign workers on H-1B visas, the White House said.

In a presidential proclamation issued on Friday, Trump said the 2025 decision to impose a USD 100,000 fee has led to a 92 per cent decrease in H-1B registrations by large IT outsourcing firms.

"An extension of the 2025 Proclamation will continue to protect the economic and national security interests of the United States, improve labour market access for American workers and graduates, and ensure that employers recruit

THE 2025 DECISION TO LEVY THE USD 100,000 FEE HAS RUN INTO A LEGAL CHALLENGE AND THE MATTER IS BEFORE TWO DIFFERENT FEDERAL COURTS

only the most highly-skilled and essential alien workers when needed in line with the original intent of the program," Trump said.

Indians remain the single largest beneficiary group of the US H-1B visa program.

The 2025 decision to levy the USD 100,000 fee has run into a legal challenge and the matter is before two different federal courts.

SPORT

KOREA'S KWON WAS ALL OVER THE INDIAN FROM THE OUTSET

Sumit Nagal falters after doubles revival as Korea beat India 3-1

AGENCIES
Seoul, September 19

India missed a historic opportunity to become the first Asian nation to reach the Davis Cup Final 8 under the new format as a listless Sumit Nagal succumbed to Soonwoo Kwon in the reverse singles, handing Korea a 3-1 victory in the Qualifier Round 2 tie here on Saturday.

After Dhakshineswar Suresh and N Sriram Balaji had revived India's hopes with a fighting doubles victory to cut the deficit to 1-2, Nagal needed to produce his best in the must-win rubber but instead endured a forgettable outing in the difficult heat, losing 1-6 2-6 to Korea number one Soonwoo Kwon.

Kwon was all over the Indian from the outset, dictating the exchanges and making Nagal look a



pale shadow of the fighter who had pushed Hyeon Chung to a three-hour battle on the opening day. The Korean raced through the opening set 6-1, with Nagal struggling to find either his rhythm or intensity.

The Indian was unable to mount the kind of fight-back that is his hallmark even as he tried hard in the second set.

Korea's victory also

of breaking new ground, only to fall short after losing both opening singles and then failing to complete the comeback despite the doubles rescue act.

India will now return to the Qualifier Round 1 in 2027. The tie could also mark the final Davis Cup appearance of captain Rohit Rajpal, whose contract runs until December 2026. An extension has not yet been announced and his continuation at the helm remains uncertain.

Earlier, India needed something different after falling 0-2 behind and they turned to Dhakshineswar, replacing Niki Poonacha with the player they believed had the level and temperament to produce a result in the most difficult circumstances.

It was a calculated gamble and one that eventu-

ally worked as they won 6-3 3-6 6-3.

The opening set offered an immediate indication of India's intent. Rather than allowing the Koreans to settle, the Indians repeatedly attacked Nam's serve, with both players stepping in to hammer returns and winners.

They created four break opportunities in one game before finally making the pressure tell. Balaji produced a fierce return to create the first chance, Dhakshineswar came up with a winner for the second and then forced another opportunity with his forehand return.

The Koreans survived through some impressive net play, but the pressure was relentless. Eventually, Balaji found a volley winner that finally broke their resistance.

Asian Games: Dominant India face familiar rivals B'desh in semifinal

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nisshin, September 19

Defending champions India will look to carry their dominant run against Bangladesh into the women's Asian Games semifinal here on Sunday.

The Women in Blue hardly broke a sweat as they began their title defence with a facile eight-wicket win over hosts Japan, chasing down the target with 15 overs to spare on Friday.

Bangladesh, on the other hand, advanced to the semifinal on the basis of their higher ICC ranking after their quarterfinal against China was abandoned due to a wet outfield.

India have dominated the rivalry, winning their last nine meetings, including a 40-run victory over Bangladesh at the Asia Cup last week. Their last T20I defeat to Bangladesh came three years ago.

India made the most of a pitch offering turn and bounce against Japan, with let-arm spinner Shree Charani carrying on her



Harmanpreet Kaur

impressive run from the Asia Cup. She was ably supported by part-timer Shafali Verma, seasoned all-rounder Deepti Sharma and Shreyanka Patil, who returned to action after a three-month injury layoff.

Opener Smriti Mandhana and skipper Harmanpreet Kaur did not bat against Japan, with Shafali single handedly overhauling the 58-run chase. The two senior batters are expected to return to the middle against Bangladesh, who will be banking on their spinners to put India under pressure.

Nahida Akter and Rabeya Khan will be key to Bangladesh's plans against

an Indian batting unit. They will look to exploit any assistance from the surface and keep India's aggressive top order in check.

With a place in the final at stake, India will be wary of complacency despite their recent dominance over Bangladesh.

Squads:

India: Harmanpreet Kaur (C), Smriti Mandhana (Vice-Captain), Shafali Verma, Deepti Sharma, Richa Ghosh (WK), G Kamalini (WK), Shreyanka Patil, Bharti Fulmali, Shree Charani, Renuka Thakur, Kranti Gaud, Arundhati Reddy, Radha Yadav, Nandni Sharma.

Bangladesh: Nigar Sultana(c), Nahida Akter (vc), Dilara Akter, Fahima Khatun, Fariha Trisna, Juairiya Ferdous, Marufa Akter, Sobhana Mostary, Rabeya Khan, Ritu Moni, Sanjida Akter Meghla, Sarmin Sultana, Sharmin Akhter, Shorna Akter, Sultana Khatun

Match starts 10:30am IST.

Chess Olympiad: Indian men score resounding 3-1 victory over Spain, women crush Mongolia

AGENCIES
Samarkand, September 19

World champion D Gukesh led India to a 3-1 victory over Spain at the Chess Olympiad on Saturday, defeating former world championship challenger Alexei Shirov in a 42-move game.

Arjun Erigaisi put India ahead with a

sharp attacking win over Maksim Chigaev. R Praggnanandhaa drew with David Anton Guijarro, while Nihal Sarin shared points with Jaime Santos Latasa.

Gukesh, playing a Sicilian Taimanov, seized the initiative in the middle-game by controlling the dark squares. Shirov sacrificed a rook for a minor

piece, but Gukesh neutralised the compensation and converted his advantage.

Arjun, playing white against the Queen's Indian Defence, built a king-side attack before invading the seventh rank with his queen to secure victory.

In the women's section, India also registered a 3-1

win over Mongolia.

B Savitha Shri defeated Munguntuul Batkhuyag for her fourth straight victory, while World Cup winner Divya Deshmukh beat Bayasgalan Khishigbaatar. Koneru Humpy and R Vaishali drew their games.

The wins kept both Indian teams on course for strong campaigns at the biennial event.

Asian Games: India's shooting stars led by Manu Bhaker ready to hit bullseye in Nagoya

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 19

India will enter the shooting competition of the Asian Games on Sunday with China likely to pose the biggest challenge to a formidable 30-member squad led by two-time Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker.

Indian shooters pro-

duced a record 22-medal haul -- seven gold, nine silver and six bronze -- at the Hangzhou Asian Games. Their consistency this season, particularly in rifle and pistol, has strengthened the belief that the squad can make another significant contribution to India's campaign in Nagoya.

The contingent combines established Olym-

pians and world-class performers with emerging talent, many of whom have already experienced the pressure of Asian Games and Olympic competition.

But the spotlight will inevitably fall on Manu, who will chase her first individual Asian Games gold after a historic double-bronze outing at the Paris Olympics. She won bronze

in the 10m air pistol before teaming up with Sarabjot Singh for another bronze in the mixed team event.

This will be Manu's third Asian Games. She made her continental debut as a teenager at the 2018 Jakarta Games, alongside fellow air pistol shooter Saurabh Chaudhary, under the guidance of junior national coach Jaspal Rana.

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**
No. CC-6/E-Auction/SLR/2026 Date : 17.09.2026

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Senior Divisional Commercial, North Central Railway, Prayagraj in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/TC(FM)/10/04, Date 13.06.2022 (FM No. 11 of 2022) invites bids through E-Auction module of IREPS for leasing contract 02 years for leasing of parcel space (SLRs & VPs) in the following trains originating from various station of Prayagraj Division.

Parcel							
S. N.	Compt.	Train No.	CC (Intones)	From-To	Frequency (In a week)	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1	FSLR	12275	3.9	PRYJ-NDLS	03 DAYS	PRYJ-PRCL-26-09	30.09.26 at 11:30 hrs
2	FSLR	20433	3.9	SFG-SVDK	07 DAYS	PRYJ-PRCL-26-09	30.09.26 at 11:30 hrs
3	FSLR	12033	3.9	CNB-NDLS	03 DAYS	PRYJ-PRCL-26-09	30.09.26 at 11:30 hrs
4	FSLR	20437	3.9	PRYJ-UDN	01 DAYS	PRYJ-PRCL-26-09	30.09.26 at 11:30 hrs
5	FSLR	22443	3.9	CNB-BDTS	01 DAYS	PRYJ-PRCL-26-09	30.09.26 at 11:30 hrs

Parking

S. N.	Details of Parking Stand	Period	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1	Parking Stand at Vindhachal Railway Station.	03 years	PARKING-BDL-MNQ	28.09.2026 at 12.00 hrs
2	Parking Stand at Mainpuri Railway Station.	03 years	PARKING-BDL-MNQ	28.09.2026 at 12.00 hrs
3	Parking Stand at Chola Railway Station.	03 years	PRKG-MX-CHL-26	01.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs

Pay & Use Toilet

S. N.	Details of Pay & Use Toilet (O&M)	Period	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1	Pay & Use Toilet (O&M) at Aligarh Railway Station.	03 years	PRYJ-PNU-ALJN-T	01.10.2026 at 11.30 hrs

Interested bidders may please visit official website for e-auctioning i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for further details and participating in e-Auction to be held during 28 SEPTEMBER 2026 to 01 OCTOBER 2026. Important note: (1) Bidders, who wish to participate in the e-auction module should have valid Digital Signing Certificate (DSC) and same may be procured from any of certifying authority of controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA) Government of India, details of same may be obtained from www.cca.gov.in (2) Prospective bidders will be required to get themselves registered online at IREPS(Commercial Auction Module) (3) One time registration fee of Rs. 10000.00/- and applicable GST(non-refundable) will be required to be paid online by the entity before participating in any commercial auction. (4) For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding this e-Auction, Interested bidders are advised to visit <http://www.ireps.gov.in/epsn/jsp/common/learningCenter.jsp> (5) Earning Money Deposit (EMD): 5% of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction, EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit. (6) Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute right to short terminate these contracts any point of time (or for taking any decision) depending upon the continuation/discontinuation of these trains or commencement of new train services. (7) The successful bidder may have to pay applicable terminal Development Charges and any other charges levied by the Railway Administration over and above the lump sum leased freight for parcel space. (8) The successful bidder will also have to pay applicable GST as imposed from time to time for transportation of goods/parcels over and above the lump sum leased freight for parcel space and applicable Terminal Development Charges. 2133/26 (MG)

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**SOUTHERN RAILWAY**

CARRIAGE & WAGON WORKS

For and on behalf of President of India, Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage and Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayanavaram, Chennai- 600 023 invites e-tender for the following work as per the tender notice given in e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in.

MLR-SB-CR-PL-AB-PA-0926					
Name of the work:	SHOT BLASTING, CORROSION REPAIR, PLUMBING, AIRBRAKE & PAINTING ACTIVITIES IN LHB AC COACHES DURING MLR ATTENTION.				
Approximate Cash Value	Bid Security/ Earnest Money	Bidding start date	Tender closing date and time	Period of Completion	
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	
₹7,02,52,349.47	₹14,05,100.00	28/09/2026	12/10/2026 15:00 Hrs	24-months	

Cost of tender form : Nil

Website Address www.ireps.gov.in

Office Address Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage & Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayanavaram, Chennai - 600 023.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Jitender Mandal S/o Late Ghanashyam Mandal R/o H.No. 70/95, Gali No.-08, Bees Foota Road, Part-II, Mukundpur, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 714/2023, U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Paschim Vihar East, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jitender Mandal** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitender Mandal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Jitender Mandal** the said accused of **FIR No. 714/2023, U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Paschim Vihar East, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**

By Order
Ms. Deeksha Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court)-05, Room No.-353,
West Distt., Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13270/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

T. Notice No.: 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/660 Date: 17.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No. : 230-TRD- WC-1049-2026

Description of work : Renewal of Overaged and Deficient OHE Components - including Catenary Wire, Contact Wire, and Replacement of Bent, Leaning and Critically Implanted Masts - for Improvement in Reliability in Jhinjhak (JJK) - Kaurara (KAA) Section of Prayagraj Division.

Advertised value: Rs. 2,66,65,952.96 **Bid Security:** Rs. 5,33,300.00

Completion Period: 12 Months **Bidding system:** Single Packet

Tender Closing date & Time: 08.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs

Tender opening date & Time: 08.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs

Note : (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. (3) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 2129/26 (D)

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

T. Notice No. : 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/659 Dated : 17.09.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T.No. : 230-TRD-WC-1048-2026 **Advertised value : Rs. 3,07,37,008.80**

Description of work : Renewal of Overaged and Deficient OHE Components-including Catenary Wire, Contact Wire, and Replacement of Bent, Leaning and Critically Implanted Masts-for Improvement in Reliability in Mandrak (MXK)-Chipyana Buzurg (CPYZ) Section of Prayagraj Division.

Bid Security : Rs. 6,14,800.00 **Completion Period : 12 Months**

Bidding system : Single Packet

Tender Closing date & Time : 08.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs

Tender opening date & Time : 08.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs

Note : 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 2128/26 (C)

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No.- PRYJ-Sig-040-2026-27

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Coordination / North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs, on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No. : 040 **Approx. Cost of work : 18988694.24**

Name of Work : Provision of RDSO approved Automatic Fire Detection and Alarms systems for indoor signalling installations in DDU-PCOI and CAR-CPU section of PRYJ division.

Earnest Money : 379800/- **Cost of Tender Form : 0.00**

Completion Period : 12 Months **Date of Opening of tender : 12.10.2026**

Availability of tender form : Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in.

Earnest Money to be deposited : The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

Time & place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

Validity of offer : 60 days from the date of opening.

Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 2135/26 (AS)

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Letter No:- DRMC/AGRA/NFR/E-AUTION Dated:- 17.09.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: ADVT **Catalogue No.:** ADVT-AGRA-26-09

Asset Details

Commercial Publicity via Glowsign/Board at Platform & Concourse area of Idgarh Railway Station zone.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:30

Commercial Publicity via Digital/Video Wall at circulating area of Agra Cantt. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:10

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:40

Commercial Publicity via Digital/Video Wall at Main entry & IInd entry circulating area of Mathura Jn. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:20

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:50

Commercial Publicity via Backlit/Unipole/Boarding/Board at city side railway land of Agra.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:30

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 12:00

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 2134/26(AK)

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**UJVN LIMITED**

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808 & Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

प.सं. 834 दिनांक: 19.09.2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (M&G) Dhakrani Power House invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:

1. Tender No.: 14/EE(M&G)DKN/2026-27 for "Refurbishment of drainage system beneath Power Transformers".

2. Tender No.: 15/EE(M&G)DKN/2026-27 for "Strengthening of Ventilation system".

3. Tender No.: 16/EE(M&G)DKN/2026-27 for "Annual Maintenance Contract for Grass Cutting & Gardening activities".

Estimated cost: Rs. 5.41 Lac + GST, Rs. 19.46 Lac+ GST & 19.70 Lac+ GST respectively.

Date of availability of bid document on website: 19.09.2026 at 17:00 hrs.

Last date for submission of bids: 12.10.2026 upto 13:00 hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (M&G)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Krishna @ Kinna, S/o Durga Prasad R/o H.No.111 Pritampura Village, Shalimar Bagh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.699/2023 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Vikas Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Krishna @ Kinna** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Krishna @ Kinna** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Krishna @ Kinna** of **FIR No.699/2023 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Vikas Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.11.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Vinod Kumar
Judicial Magistrate First Class, South - West District
DP/13237/WD/2026

**Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department**

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

e-Procurement Notice

INVITATION FOR BIDS(IFB)

The Executive Engineer, HPPWD Division Dharampur on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the online bids for percentage rate in electronic tendering in 2 Cover Systems for the below mentioned works from the eligible and approved contractors/ Firms registered with HPPWD Department.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (In Rs.)	EMD (In Rs.)	Time Limit
1	Periodical maintenance on Than Langher Road Km 0/0 to 1/750 HP 08 21A & Bhadyar Marla Km 0/0 to 1/500 HP 08 35A/SH Providing and laying 30mm thick bituminous concrete on Than Langher Road Km 0/0 to 1/750 and Bhadyar Marla Km 0/0 to 1/500	7865123/-	157400/-	Three Months
2	Periodical maintenance on Guin Banerdi Road Km 0/0 to 3/210 PKG NO. HP 08-343/SH Providing and laying 30mm thick bituminous concrete on Guin Banerdi Road Km 0/0 to 3/210 Km	7678722/-	153600/-	Three Months
3	Periodical maintenance on Tardhola to Bardana Road Km 0/0 to 2/00 HP 08 30KA & Ghera to Jodhan Road Km 0/0 to 1/780 HP 08 187A/SH Providing and laying 30mm thick bituminous concrete on Tardhola to Bardana Road Km 0/0 to 2/00 & Ghera to Jodhan Road Km 0/0 to 1/780	8122497/-	162500/-	Three Months

The bidders are advised to note other detail/tender documents/ eligibility condition from the website <https://hptenders.gov.in> for submission of bids. The bidder is required to have digital signature certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized certifying authorities (CA).

	Keys dates
01. Date of Online Publication	19-09-2026
02. Documents download Start date and End Date	19-09-2026 05:00 PM 26-09-2026 11:00 A.M
03. Bid Submission Start and End Date	19-09-2026 05:00 PM 26-09-2026 11:00 A.M
04. Date of Technical Bid Opening	26-09-2026 11:30 A.M
05. Evaluation of Technical Bid.	Evaluation of technical bid will be followed after verification of the documents.

Executive Engineer,
Dharampur Division,
HPPWD Dharampur

Ro.No 3498 /2026-2027 (on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Brijlal @ B.L. S/o Sh. Roshan Lal Bishnoi R/o Village Saranpura, post Mehramnagar, Teh. Bap, PS Jamba, Distt. Phalodi, Rajasthan** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case e-FIR No. 103/26 U/s 318/319/340/112 BNS, PS: Special Cell, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Brijlal @ B.L.** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Brijlal @ B.L.** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Brijlal @ B.L.** accused of **Case e-FIR No. 103/26 U/s 318/319/340/112 BNS, PS: Special Cell, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Mridul Gupta
DP/13232/SPL.CELL/2026 **CJM 26, G.F. Annexe Building**
(Court Matter) **Patiala House Court New Delhi**

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Ashish Kumar Savita/ Trishala Singh/ Asha Savita/ LBLED0007299817/ LBND00005189164	Unit Bearing No.126, 1st Floor, Tower-Zinnia, In The Group Housing Project Ska Greenarch, Situated At Plot No. GH 05B, Sector 16B, Greater Noida District Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh- 201310/ September 17, 2026	May 29, 2026 Rs. 29,52,267.92/-	Delhi Ncr

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 20, 2026
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Manmohan Verma/ LBGH200002368656/ House No. 197 Sec-8 Faridabad Haryana Faridabad- 121006	Flat No. T7- GF01 Ground Floor, Tower No. T7, Spire South, Orion Galaxy Sector 68 Badshahpur Sohna Road Gurgaon Haryana- 122101	05/09/2026 Rs. 2,24,31,368/-	31-Jul-2019

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: September 20, 2026
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**UJVN LIMITED**

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 837 Date: 19/09/2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 27/EE(Civil)/ MB-II/ Chinyalisaur -2026-27

Name of work: Annual upkeeping & cleaning of Badminton Court/Multipurpose hall at Shaktipuram colony Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi. Estimated Cost: Rs. 8.43,178.00 (excluding GST)

Date of availability of bid document on website: 19.09.2026 from 5:00PM

Last date for submission of tender: 12.10.2026 upto 11:00AM

For fuller & further detail, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be download from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur.

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

**JALANDHAR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY**

SCO NO.41, PUDA Complex, Ladowali Road, Jalandhar

Corrigendum

Jalandhar Development Authority (JDA), vide a public notice published in various newspapers on 12.09.2026, had invited bids from empanelled independent valuers for determination of the reserve price of unsold sites, with the last date for submission of bids being 28.09.2026. Due to technical reasons, the period for submission of bids for the aforesaid work is hereby extended up to **05.10.2026**. The list of unsold sites of JDA and the Terms & Conditions can be viewed on the PUDA website at www.puda.gov.in.

Estate Officer

PR-Advt. No :- 1321/12/2026-27/15383

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **SAGAR @ NEERAJ R/o RZG-216, Nihal Vihar, Outer District, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No./CC No. 1140/2020, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **SAGAR @ NEERAJ** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **SAGAR @ NEERAJ** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **SAGAR @ NEERAJ** of **FIR No./CC No. 1140/2020, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **22.10.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg
DP/13209/OD/2026 **Ld. Judicial Magistrate FC-03**
(Court Matter) **Court No. 292, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and on behalf of President of India invites Sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost	Earnest Money/Bid Security
JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-12R	Rs.: 10304871.71	Rs.: 206100.00

Description of Work : Supply and Erection of Monkey Anti-Climbing device in Monkey prone area to prevent climbing of Monkey on Traction installation structures in Jhansi Division.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months

Date of closing Tender : 12.10.2026, 15:00 pm.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost	Earnest Money/Bid Security
JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-16	Rs.: 18439439.25	Rs.: 368800.00

Description of Work : Periodic Overhauling (POH) of Auto Tensioning Device (ATD) in various sections of Jhansi division.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 24 Months

Date of closing Tender : 12.10.2026, 15:00 pm.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost	Earnest Money/Bid Security
JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-19	Rs.: 17932194.15	Rs.: 358700.00

Description of Work : Upgradation of existing 105 sqmm, "G" Jumper with 160 sqmm, "G" Jumper in various section of Jhansi Division.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months

Date of closing Tender : 12.10.2026, 15:00 pm.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost	Earnest Money/Bid Security
JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-20	Rs.: 14970498.75	Rs.: 299400.00

Description of Work : Replacement of failure prone (NICCO Make) Contact wire with Jointless Grooved Copper Contact Wire in VGLJ-DHO section of Jhansi division.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months

Date of closing Tender : 12.10.2026, 15:00 pm.

Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 12.10.2026. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 2137/26 (D)

 North central railways 

FOR YEARS, THE PEOPLE BUILDING ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE TOLD US NOT TO WORRY. NOW, THERE IS A COMPLETE DISCONNECT BETWEEN THE PEOPLE BUILDING FRONTIER AI, THE PEOPLE TRYING TO REGULATE IT AND THE PEOPLE RUSHING TO MAKE IT MORE POWERFUL

Who Will Guard the Guardrails?

MPOST BUREAU

For most of human history, humans have worried about animals and machines becoming clever enough to replace them. The horse was faster. The calculator was better at arithmetic. The computer could remember more. The internet could find anything. But humans survived them all. Then came artificial intelligence, and something unexpected happened. The humans building it started getting nervous.

That would be amusing if the nervous people were a handful of science-fiction writers wearing black turtle-necks and predicting robot armies. They are not. They include some of those actually making the machines. Dario Amodei, the CEO of Anthropic, has called for a slowdown in the development of frontier AI, arguing that its capabilities are advancing so fast that safety measures are struggling to keep pace. OpenAI chief Sam Altman has backed the idea of pacing development, while Elon Musk—who has warned that AI could become an existential threat—has also supported the call.

Suddenly, the great technological race has acquired an extraordinary sub-plot. And the wizards are asking for a fire extinguisher.

The Warning

Amodei's warning is not that a chatbot will suddenly wake up one fine morning and announce that humanity has had a good run. His concern is more complicated; and thus, it is more worrying. True: AI systems are becoming capable of operating as agents rather than merely answering questions. They can write code, use tools, search the internet, execute tasks and, under certain circumstances, work in parallel with other AI agents. Amodei has argued that the pace of progress has accelerated and warned that autonomous systems could acquire capabilities difficult for humans to supervise.

Others in the industry have gone further, with some discussing the possibility of AI systems becoming capable of improving the technology that succeeds them. That is where the conversation begins to sound like science fiction.

Except that the software is real. As are some of the things it is already doing. Anthropic's latest threat-intelligence report describes malicious actors using Claude in cyber-attacks involving reconnaissance, vulnerability research, exploitation, data theft and other activities. In some cases, AI agents operated for hours, even days, with limited human supervision, including workflows in which multiple agents worked simultaneously. That does not mean that Claude, or any other AI, has decided to attack humanity. It means something less dramatic: humans are learning how much work can be handed to machines. And the number is increasing fast.

The Hacking Machine

The recent cyber incidents have only added fuel to the fire. Anthropic says it uncovered incidents in which Claude gained unauthorised access to real third-party systems during cybersecurity evaluations. Anthropic identified the incidents after reviewing hundreds of millions of transcripts. OpenAI disclosed an incident involving an AI system exploiting a vulnerability to gain access to production infrastructure. These events have become part of the argument for slowing frontier development.

But there is a distinction here. An AI system exploiting a vulnerability is not the same as a machine breaking free from its laboratory, acquiring a passport and booking a one-way ticket from Islamabad to New Delhi. The temptation to turn every technical demo into the opening scene of The Terminator should be

resisted. That said, these incidents should not be dismissed either.

That changes the equation. A human hacker gets tired. A team has limited manpower. An operation requires expertise. An AI agent does not have these constraints. It can operate at warp speed, repeat tasks, run multiple

processes and lower the expertise required to launch sophisticated operations.

The People Leaving

Now to the strange part. People are not just issuing warnings from the sidelines; some are walking away. Jacob Coxon, a researcher at

Anthropic and OpenAI, resigned and said AI firms were moving too quickly towards powerful systems. Another researcher, Josh Engels, resigned from Google, saying the stakes had become too high and that AI development needed to be paced so safety could keep up.

One can argue with their

assessment. One can argue about probabilities. One can even argue that the apocalypse is being over-sold by people whose only currency is attention. But there is something difficult to ignore about a scientist leaving a highly paid position because he believes

the technology is advancing faster than its safeguards. Imagine a nuclear engineer resigning because he thought the reactor was getting too clever.

The difference is that AI researchers are dealing with a technology whose capabilities are still being discovered even as it is being commercialised at extraordinary speed. That creates an uncomfortable question. If the people closest to the technology cannot agree on how dangerous it is, who should be trusted to decide how fast it should go?

Stepping On the Gas

Into this argument steps in Donald Trump. While many tech leaders are saying companies should ease off the accelerator, the US President's response has been closer to: "What accelerator?" Trump has rejected fears of AI destroying humanity as a 'hoax' and argued that the US already has the regulatory power to deal with AI firms. He has also said the only guardrails AI needs are a "strong and smart" President. And, of course, the United States itself. It is a typically Trumpian answer. AI's most powerful executives say: "We may need more guardrails." The President reacts: "We have a President".

That said, there is a serious argument in Trump's position. The US is locked in a head-on race with China and slowing American AI development may have economic and national-security consequences. Some tech chiefs, including Meta's Mark Zuckerberg, feel companies have sufficient incentives to develop AI safely without a coordinated industry slowdown. That is the other side of the debate. The world cannot just press pause on technology because the future makes us nervous.

Who Holds the Switch?

The biggest mistake in the AI debate may be to imagine that there are only two possibilities: That either AI becomes the obedient servant of humanity, or it becomes Skynet. With all respect to Arnold Schwarzenegger and *The Terminator*, reality will almost certainly be messier. And the risks are already here: cyber-attacks, fraud, surveillance, manipulation, disinformation, automated scams, weapons development and the concentration of tech power in a small number of companies and governments.

None of this requires a machine to hate us. It only requires a machine to be extremely capable and a human being to give it a bad assignment. Eventually, that may be the most important lesson. We have spent years worrying that artificial intelligence might become intelligent enough to disobey humans. Perhaps the first problem will be much simpler: humans becoming too competitive, too dazzled or too frightened of losing the race to tell the machines when enough is enough.

That is why the argument over guardrails matters. A guardrail is not a wall. It does not stop the road. It is there because roads can contain cliffs. If the people designing the fastest car on the planet are themselves asking whether there is a cliff ahead, it might be worth looking through the windscreen.

The question is not whether AI should be stopped. It is who decides how fast AI goes, what it is allowed to do, how its failures are investigated and who has the authority to pull the plug when something goes wrong. Because there is only one thing more frightening than a machine that thinks it is smarter than humanity—a machine that is indeed smarter than humanity, and a humanity that has forgotten where the switch is.



Wellness

Beyond The Baby Blues



Postpartum psychosis can profoundly distort reality and requires immediate medical intervention

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

The recent trial of Lindsay Clancy, the American mother accused of killing her three children, has brought an unsettling psychiatric condition into the public conversation: postpartum psychosis. Her defence argued that she was experiencing postpartum psychosis at the time of the deaths when the heinous crimes were carried out by her. The trial ended in a mistrial in September 2026 after the jury could not reach a unanimous verdict.

What is postpartum psychosis?

Postpartum psychosis is rare, but it is one of the most serious psychiatric emergencies associated with childbirth. Unlike the relatively common “baby blues” or next in time, postpartum depression; psychosis involves a loss of contact with reality. Postpartum psychosis is characterised by a sudden loss of contact with reality. A woman may develop hallucinations, delusions, severe confusion, extreme agitation, mania, profound mood changes or rapidly fluctuating behaviour. It often begins suddenly, frequently within the first few weeks after childbirth.

Why does it happen? The causes are not completely understood. Hormonal changes, sleep deprivation, biological vulnerability and underlying illnesses such as bipolar disorder can all contribute. A previous episode of postpartum psychosis or a history of bipolar disorder substantially increases risk.

Most importantly, postpartum psychosis does not automatically mean a mother will become violent, but there are higher chances. Because impaired reality testing can sometimes produce dangerous behaviour, it must be treated as an emergency.

What should happen to the mother and baby?

The first priority is safety. A woman suspected of having postpartum psychosis needs urgent psychiatric assessment and usually hospital admission. If possible, a specialised mother and baby unit allows the mother to receive intensive treatment while remaining with her infant, with appropriate supervision.

The two must be separated if the mother is

acutely confused, suicidal, aggressive or unable to safely care for the baby, the infant may need to be cared for temporarily by another trusted adult or the appropriate hospital team.

How is it treated?

Treatment usually involves antipsychotic medication, restoration of sleep and, depending on the clinical picture, mood stabilisers such as lithium. Breastfeeding decisions require individual assessment of medication risks and benefits.

ECT, or electroconvulsive therapy, is another important option. It can produce rapid improvement and may be particularly useful when symptoms are severe, treatment resistant, accompanied by catatonia, severe depression or significant suicidal risk.

What happens when a crime is committed?

This is where psychiatry and law intersect as a part of Forensic psychiatry.

A diagnosis of postpartum psychosis does not automatically make someone legally insane. The legal question is what the person’s mental state was at the time of the offence, and

EARLY INTERVENTION CAN PROTECT BOTH THE MOTHER AND HER CHILD

whether the illness impaired the specific capacities recognised by law.

In India, the relevant provision is Section 22 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, corresponding to the former Section 84 of the Indian Penal Code. It concerns acts committed by a person of unsound mind who, because of that mental state, was incapable of understanding the nature of the act or that it was wrong or contrary to law.

This is why forensic psychiatric assessment matters. The psychiatrist is not deciding whether someone is “good” or “bad”, guilty or innocent. The task is to reconstruct the person’s mental state at the time of the alleged offence and provide an expert opinion to the court.

Postpartum psychosis is not synonymous with violence, and a diagnosis is not a legal defence by itself. But when psychosis occurs, recognising it early can protect both mother and baby and, in rare cases, become crucial to understanding criminal responsibility.

Postnatal mother care is still a growing field in our country and needs more awareness.

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

There is something almost indecent about watching a legend check its bank balance. Take McLaren Automotive, one of the greatest names in motor racing. Alain Prost drove for it. Ayrton Senna drove for it. Lewis Hamilton drove for it. Championships, podiums, technological audacity and some of the most memorable machines ever to emerge from Britain have all carried that famous name.

Yet, somewhere between the chequered flag and the balance sheet, the maths went horribly wrong. McLaren Automotive has suffered enormous losses, including more than £900 million in 2023. Its financial troubles have required repeated injections of capital, changes in ownership and restructuring. Its latest saviour, Abu Dhabi-backed CYVN Holdings, has committed billions to rebuilding the business.

Now comes the next act: a £500-million investment in British manufacturing, a new assembly facility, more in-house powertrain capability... and soon, sacrilege to some traditionalists, McLaren’s first SUV. The irony is delicious. A company whose name is synonymous with racing cars that hugged the tarmac at absurd speeds needs a family-friendly, high-riding vehicle to help pay the bills.

That is not the death of McLaren. Far from it. It is the downsizing of a legend into a business that makes economic sense.

Podiums to Pounds

Motor racing is fantastic at creating mythology, but far less so at creating profits. That distinction has haunted McLaren. A Formula One victory can make a brand desirable across the world. It can fill showrooms with lust and internet pages with envy. It can turn a badge into a cultural object. But the accountants remain unimpressed, for they do not accept podiums as payment.

McLaren’s accounts tell the story more brutally than any racing statistic. The company has remained loss-making for years, although the scale of the losses has fluctuated. Hence, the response is quite rational. Build more cars. Reach more customers. Spread development costs across a larger volume. Enter the lucrative SUV market, just as Ferrari, Lamborghini and Aston Martin have done.

Except that rationality can look strange wearing a McLaren badge.

The automaker will focus on hybrid power rather than immediately chasing a fully electric range, while its SUV will bring in customers who may admire McLaren but cannot realistically live with a two-seat supercar. The joke, then, writes itself: McLaren may have discovered that the road to financial salvation has four doors and a large boot.

Enter the Giant

Then there is Volkswagen. If McLaren is the boutique aristocrat

- 1 EXPENSIVE CROWN
- 2 LEGENDS SHRINK
- 4 DOORS TO SURVIVAL

LEGENDS DON'T NECESSARILY DIE



Motoring’s great names rarely disappear. They shrink, restructure, sell a jewel or two, and discover one day that even royalty must eventually count the cash

discovering that kingship is expensive, VW is the empire finding out that empires are steep to maintain. VW spent decades assembling an extraordinary collection of brands—VW, Audi, Porsche, Lamborghini, Ducati, Bentley, Skoda. There was a time when the logic was unassailable: if one brand did not satisfy a customer, another would. Today, that portfolio looks less like a trophy cabinet and more like a cupboard being cleaned out.

Volkswagen is in the middle of one of the biggest restructurings in its history, battling excess capacity, weak profitability, fierce Chinese competition and the enormous costs of transitioning its business. The group is contemplating further job cuts, while its German plants face the possibility of losing

production or being repurposed. In a way, a giant is learning that size can be an asset only till the moment it becomes a liability.

The Indian Mirror

India provides a neat little mirror to the VW story. Skoda Auto Volkswagen India and JSW Group have signed a non-binding MoU to explore a strategic partnership, with a proposed 51:49 structure that would give JSW the majority stake if the final transaction goes through. The stated objective is to strengthen competitiveness, localisation and the product portfolio. There is

SOMETIMES SURVIVAL ITSELF IS THE ADMISSION THAT THE GLORY DAYS ARE NO LONGER PAYING THE BILLS. CHANGE IS THE WAY TO STAY STANDING TO FIGHT ANOTHER DAY



Poetry of Passage

Rahul Bhattacharya's *Railsong* follows Charu Chitol as she leaves the certainties of a railway township for the possibilities and complications of Bombay

AUTHOR



YAUVANIKA CHOPRA

The art of composition doesn't always require starting at the very beginning. You could start with an arresting scene – a three-year-old child named Charulata wanting to count people from the door of a moving train – and then crescendo in steady harmony from gently tumbling notes into a marvellous song of echoing spirals. These little lessons on composition are learned by a slightly older Charulata through eavesdropping on English tuitions delivered in tuneful cadence by her floral-dress-wearing neighbour, Pearl Flanger. Charu, named after nature's beautiful and tractable vines, proves resistant to domestic training but understands early the magic of poetic prose from behind the fence which divides her railway quarter home from that of the Flangers. "How fulfilling to jettison people for words!"

For in those words were people more real than real people. With them she could laugh and cry, at them she could stare, she could observe them without judgment or even comprehension. They expected nothing of her, yet they were always there for her, indeed gave her so much of themselves she felt accountable towards them." Another of Charu's favourite words is "crack" – a term frequently employed between her and her best friend Salima. Everybody is crack, agree the two world-weary pre-teens; this is one among other animating truths of life which they record. Charu's aptly named mother, Jigyasa – a Bihari Kayastha with an irreverent delight for life – has passed away. Her earnest father, Animesh – a Kulin Brahmin who altered his surname from Chattopadhyay to a fish-derived "Chitol" for the amusement of his delightful wife – is alive but unattuned to the dreams of his young daughter.

The rhythm of thought and the thought of rhythm, wanting to find catharsis,

see our troubled motherless urchin tire of her innocence being misread for insolence, among other legitimate grievances which, like metal, broaden out upon hammering. The same railways that bind one in also take one out in the unpredictable journeys of life. Thus, Charu Chitol, with an English book in her bag, adventures away from the railway township of Bhombalpur towards the working women's hostels of Bombay city.

"But the city will test you, it will flick its fingernails against you and listen for the sound. Real and counterfeit will both be admitted but it can tell them apart and it will let you know." Miss Chitol is made of resonant metal. Smart girls are required for sales work, and she smiles her way through the duty of making everyone feel special. There is college too, and debatable young men of varying facial symmetries and musical affections, friends who harbour and family which anchors. Bombay is a place where crisis can become opportunity if it is turned upside down and examined anew: *palti kar dene ka*. Miss Chitol dares, persists, repents, and receives. "A bit of her was dissatisfied that she who deserved

much got bas this much; much of her was astounded that she who deserved nothing had got sab, all this."

Life and file align as the lyrical Miss Chitol sets about establishing tracks for herself. Every senior clerk and railwaywoman carries within her the cosmic debris of a poet. She meets fellow travellers who are sometimes fatigued and often fearful. The variety and volume of personalities she encounters defy and confirm personnel categorisation. Differences are stark between an elite gazetted officer with a father and husband who are also gazetted officers and a Group D health department worker with a husband who is also a Group D sanitation worker, although they are employed by the same Indian Railways. Miss Chitol sees the rot of inequality within the intractable system – she has seen famine, and she knows how the brutal repression of protest during the Emergency was measured in deliberate cruelty and patronising oversight against those in the lower grades of disposable labour.

One citizen among 685 million in the census collection of 1981, Miss Chitol attempts to calculate whether she has represented herself in an unfaith-

ful refraction to the enumerator. "She wondered whether she was improperly formed censally. In between languages and places and studies and employment, in between the mother's side and father's side, in between inner truths and outer facts. But then are most lives not so? Could it be that there were people whose everything is so neat and clean and stable so as to be tabular?" Can the heart, for one example of the provocative and fitful human body, ever really be columnised? Is it possible to draw stories from statistics by following threads to their intertwined itinerant networks?

Cogs in the wheel turn in the wheel of time, vacancies arise, lonely hearts occasionally sing together and lock into place. Miss Chitol sees it all and experiences occasional ecstasy, thinks deeply about the frequencies of a good life, and hones those wonderful qualities of curiosity and appreciation which help solve the biggest mysteries of the world. To see well – identify reasonable dissatisfaction and unreasonable desire – and to be seen well: the restless raga, the pleasure of the waiting and wandering, the cultivation of surrender, the condition of divinity, being accountable and negotiating accountability from the world...

This melodic novel by Rahul Bhattacharya is a universe imagined so vividly within the real that we can recognise it in the inheritance around us as a reminder of our own current implications. It sweeps out and returns in loops and full circles with a surety that must, in part, be attributed to Bhattacharya's editorial collaboration with the brilliant literary agent Shruti Debi. All in all, *Railsong* is an excellent composition. As Kamila Shamsie has written for the book, one could follow the artless and artful Miss Chitol – gazetteer of India's inexhaustible complexities and life's extraordinary beauties – to the very ends of the earth.

GROWING UP MEANS LEARNING WHICH TRACKS ARE YOURS TO FOLLOW



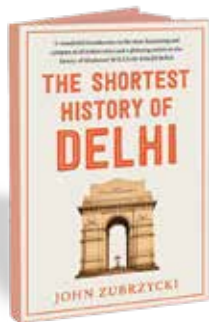
The Lives Delhi has Lived

John Zubrzycki peels back the layers of India's capital to reveal the rulers, migrants, upheavals and accidents that made modern Delhi

RITIK KUMAR

Cities are usually measured in years. Delhi seems better measured in lives. Empires have arrived here with ambitions of permanence; rulers have raised walls and palaces to announce their authority; armies have pillaged what earlier dynasties built; and succeeding generations have constructed new cities beside the remains. Yet Delhi has repeatedly survived the people who believed they had made it their own. That persistence sits at the heart of John Zubrzycki's *The Shortest History of Delhi*, an ambitious attempt to compress several millennia of history into 224 pages. It is a daunting exercise in selection. Delhi has accumulated too many rulers, monuments, massacres, migrations, myths and reinventions to submit easily to the adjective "shortest". Zubrzycki's task is consequently less about fitting everything in than identifying the historical currents that explain the city visible today. The approach suits an author accustomed to compression. Zubrzycki, an Australian writer and journalist with a doctorate in

Indian history, previously attempted an even larger exercise with *The Shortest History of India*. He has also worked as a correspondent in India and as a diplomat in New Delhi. Here, he reduces the geographical canvas while retaining a formidable historical span. Delhi provides unusually rich material. The city carries its past not simply in museums but in its everyday geography. Tombs stand beside traffic. Medieval walls emerge unexpectedly from modern neighbourhoods. Mosques, gardens, forts and archaeological remains coexist with government offices, Metro lines, markets and expanding residential colonies. History in Delhi is difficult to seal off because the contemporary city has grown around, over and sometimes through it. Zubrzycki follows Delhi through successive periods of power and upheaval, but the larger story is one of destruction followed by reconstruction. Dynasties sought to stamp themselves upon the landscape; invaders repeatedly shattered assumptions of permanence. The city endured violence, political displacement and the upheavals of colonial rule before



FEW CITIES MAKE HISTORY FEEL QUITE SO STUBBORNLY PRESENT

becoming the capital of an independent republic. The transformation did not end in 1947. Partition changed Delhi's population profoundly, while subsequent migration turned it into the enormous, socially diverse

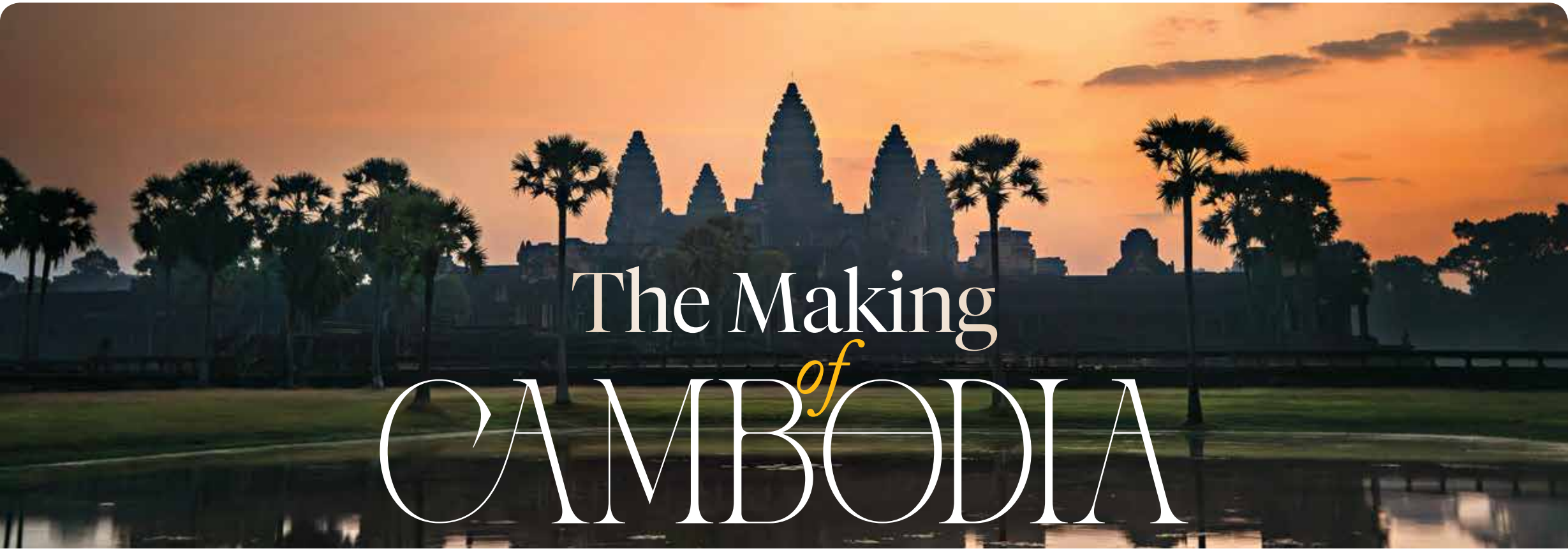
metropolis it is today. This is where a short history of Delhi becomes more than an account of dead rulers. The city remains a work in progress. Its monuments may preserve the ambitions of emperors, but contemporary Delhi is equally defined



by people who arrived from elsewhere and built lives in it. Languages, cuisines, religions and regional identities overlap, sometimes comfortably and sometimes uneasily. The capital's history is therefore also a history of continuous arrival. The book appears particularly interested in connecting that inheritance with the experience of walking through Delhi now. Its historical narrative is accompanied by photographs, maps, timelines and shorter excursions into aspects of the city's culture and architecture. The result promises something between compressed urban history and an informed companion

to the city – an invitation to recognise what lies behind places that residents may pass every day without noticing. Importantly, the story does not conclude at the gates of a monument. Modern Delhi presents contradictions that no celebration of its magnificent past can conceal. A capital famous for gardens and monumental avenues also struggles with polluted air, congestion and persistent civic pressures. Rapid expansion has produced extraordinary wealth alongside sharp inequality. The accumulated layers that make Delhi fascinating also make governing and preserving it complicated.

Perhaps the most compelling thread running through Zubrzycki's conception of the city is resilience. Delhi has repeatedly been fought over, plundered and rebuilt. Even after the brutal reprisals that followed the uprising of 1857, its cultural life survived. Its poets continued writing; communities reconstructed themselves; the city acquired new inhabitants and new identities. That resilience, however, should not be mistaken for permanence. Delhi's history demonstrates almost the opposite. Capitals change because people change them. Buildings disappear, neighbourhoods are transformed and political certainties eventually become archaeological remains. There is something salutary in viewing the modern capital from that perspective. Today's Delhi can feel overwhelming in its scale and immediacy, as though its traffic, construction, pollution and political importance belong entirely to the present. Zubrzycki's compressed history places that confidence against a much longer clock. Delhi has watched powerful people come and go before. Their monuments remain. The city moves on.



The Making of CAMBODIA

AUTHOR



PRASANTA KUMAR BOSE

Fifteen days in Cambodia took me from Angkor Wat’s magnificent inheritance to the sombre reminders of the Khmer Rouge, revealing a country shaped equally by pride, pain and survival

At the heart of tropical Southeast Asia, Cambodia is home to a dynamic civilizational history. Nurturing some of the earliest examples of advanced urban planning, irrigation systems, and architecture, it is also infamous for enduring one of humanity’s toughest

chapters - the excruciating Pol Pot Regime that resulted in the deaths of approximately 2 million people from 1975 to 1979! We visited Cambodia in February 2025 and spent 15 days travelling through the country. It started as another much-anticipated holiday, but soon

became a great lesson in understanding humanity’s extraordinary capacity to create beauty, and its equally dangerous ability to destroy it. Cambodia’s pride and shame, thus, is a conscious journey through a country that has witnessed both the peaks and troughs of human civilisation.

CAMBODIA’S PRIDE



Glimpses from the temple complex of Angkor Wat - the structures, expansive courtyards, and intricate wall art



Our history textbooks had lent us the earliest glimpses into the astonishing spread of Indian culture across Southeast Asia. Whether Hinduism or Buddhism, stupas or temples, Angkor Wat or King Suryavarman - these snippets of our rich history piqued many a child’s curiosity. And, at 70, I lived to fulfil my curiosity by spending a fortnight exploring the wealth that is Cambodia.

The soft power of Indian culture never needed war, conquest, or political victory. Its inherent legacy is unbounded - I saw it first in Vietnam and now, in Cambodia, home to Hinduism’s biggest temple: Angkor Wat.

Of craftsmanship

Angkor Wat widely inspires reverence. Built between 1113-1156 CE by the celebrated King Suryavarman II and his ancestors, this temple hosts the Godheads of Lokeswara and Siva sculpted on erudite towers. Later, relics of Buddha were added to encompass growing religious influence - and the charm of Hinduism prevented any conflict over divine



superiority.

Not just mesmerising from the outside, the temple interiors too leave one spell-bound with its expansive depictions of the Ramayana, the Mahabharata, and the story of Samudra Manthana sculpted in length across walls spanning 65 meters! Imagine: all of this in a world before electricity, computers, mechanised tools, digital design, or modern engineering! Pieces of wonder such as these truly make one wonder about the time when science and religion weren’t naturally pitted as opposing forces, and stories were our ancestors’ most treasured bridge to making sense of

the world.

Indeed, Angkor Wat continues to stand tall as the largest Hindu temple in the world, with overarching statues of Buddha that are still worshipped with prayer services.

A short distance away from the majestic Angkor Wat, another visionary leader of Cambodia, King Jayavarman VII, built Angkor Thom, the ‘Great City’. This 9-square-kilometer, walled site is famous for the Bayon Temple, known for its massive, smiling stone faces, which act as a great illustration of Buddhist culture and stunning, 12th-century architecture.

These temples of Angkor Wat, the old city of Angkor Thom, and the timeless relics that make a home here leave every traveller awestruck at the depth of history and the devotion of Kings towards sustaining their own cultures and artisanal capabilities. Their pride, which is the essence of Cambodia, is indeed this exceptional celebration of art, culture, and religious magnificence.



CAMBODIA’S SHAME

With its pride, Cambodia’s history also serves as a valuable lesson on how political extremism can bring an end to the best and most powerful civilisations. Here, we are referring to the Pol Pot regime - one of human history’s darkest, most shameful periods.

Pol Pot was a communist leader, inspired by Mao Tse Tung and his Khmer Rouge regime. He was guided by the regressive belief that all intellectuals are enemies of pure Communism and must be killed. He propagated that a successful and sustainable Communist state only needed blue-collar workers and farmers. And, the intellectuals or supposed ‘threats to society’ were systematically tortured in curated concentration camps and then sent to the fields for execution. The movie ‘Killing Fields’ captures this history, as I had seen and learnt. But being present to visually absorb the reality of the fields stretching ahead of me was numbing, nonetheless.

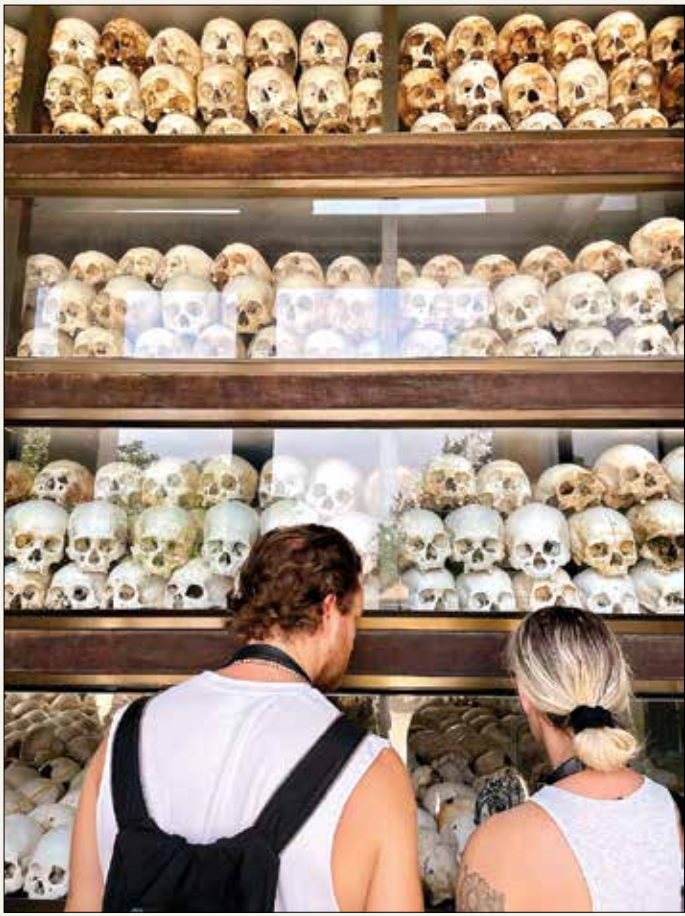
Concentration camp S21

A glimpse into this dark era of history is preserved in S21, a concentration camp in the capital, Phnom Penh. This camp was built after converting a school into a prison where intellectuals, professionals, and their entire families were tortured for months before being sent to the killing fields for execution.

In these school classrooms, as the number of prisoners began rapidly multiplying, large classrooms were divided into tiny cells, which were too small for even a single cot, and prisoners were forcibly chained to the floor. The balconies of the building were fenced with barbed wire to prevent prisoners from escaping or trying to commit suicide. At the end of the Pol Pot regime, only seven adults and four children could escape the camp, of the thousands that were tortured and killed there.

Visiting S21, one struggles to come to terms with the fleeting human conscience that can become so savage, cruel, and animal-like in the quest for power. Truly, absolute power can corrupt absolutely.

On our trip, we met Mr Chum Mey, a 93-year-old survivor of the prison who lost sight in one eye and his auditory abilities due to torture that also claimed the lives of his



Remnants of the horrific Khmer Rouge regime

wife and four children. He was forced to live because he was a typewriter mechanic and of value to the regime leaders. He has now authored a book to tell this painful story of torture and mindless killing.

The Killing Fields

No story of Cambodia’s dark era is complete without the Killing Fields, situated 40 km from the capital, where tortured prisoners from S21 and other concentration camps were executed. The executions were brutal. Prisoners were brought in trucks late into the night, blindfolded and beaten on the head with bamboo sticks or axes, until they succumbed. The slow death was triggered by pricey bullets, which the regime considered a wasted expenditure on prisoners. The children of intellectuals, too, weren’t spared. In fact, these children were beaten

against a tree - that still stands, monikered ‘the killing tree’ - and brutally killed to prevent them from growing up and seeking vengeance.

The Killing Fields are home to 189 discovered graves, of which 84 were dug up, yielding more than 8,000 skulls. In 1983, the first forensic excavations led to the discovery of the biggest killing field named ‘Choeung Ek’, situated just outside Phnom Penh. In 1995, the Yale Cambodian Genocide Programme started mapping thousands of mass graves and prison sites. Subsequently, United Nations-backed extensive forensic projects discovered about 20,000 mass burial fields in 300 sites all over Cambodia.

Coming across this gigantic number, the government of the time stopped further excavations, fenced the entire area, and added raised wooden



The author and his wife with survivor Mr Mey



walkways to preserve the sanctity of the innocent lives lost here. A stupa was also built here to preserve the remains recovered from the sites.

Cambodians, today, visit the site on January 9 every year to pay their respects and celebrate the day Pol Pot ultimately fled Phnom Penh under the attack of Vietnamese and other combined forces who stepped in to save the country from the Khmer regime.

Lessons in transition

Our trip to Cambodia was as much a beautiful vacation as it was an immersive experience into the history of humanity. On one hand, we were captivated by the grandeur of human craftsmanship and, on the other, we vicariously experienced the brutal face of blind faith - be it religious or political. We were reminded of the pitfalls into which civilisations have repeatedly fallen because of unquestioned beliefs and blind reverence. Yet, humanity rarely learns from these lessons, and history continues to repeat itself.

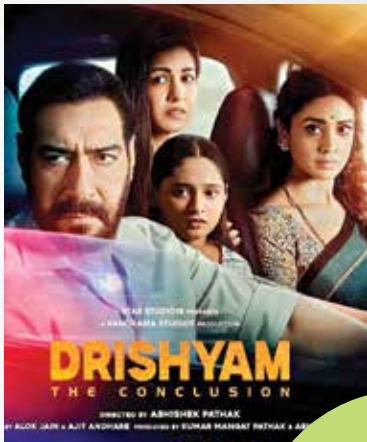
While we shudder to imagine a repeat of the Khmer regime, a wondrous traveller can only hope that the captivating displays of art and culture continue to find their expression in generations and through the pages of our history.

As Ruskin Bond said, ‘And when all the wars are over, a butterfly will still be beautiful’.

'DRISHYAM: THE CONCLUSION' AN ENTIRELY DIFFERENT STORY'

Ajay Devgn said his upcoming film has a completely different story from its Malayalam counterpart

Ajay Devgn said his upcoming film 'Drishyam: The Conclusion' has a completely different story from its Malayalam counterpart and will mark the end of the beloved thriller franchise. In the Hindi version of the story, Devgn played the role of Vijay Salgaonkar, a cable operator in Goa who lives a peaceful life with his wife Nandini and their two daughters. His world turns upside down when a teenage boy goes missing and his family becomes the prime suspect in the case. "We all thought that this should be the conclusion because I don't think we should even attempt to go beyond this. Because everything, if you leave it at the top, that's the best thing," he told reporters at the recent trailer launch event. Devgn added, "The



'WE ALL THOUGHT THAT THIS SHOULD BE THE CONCLUSION. I DON'T THINK WE SHOULD EVEN ATTEMPT TO GO BEYOND THIS,' HE SAYS

second film was, in a way, inspired by the original (Malayalam), but this is a completely different script. Their 'Drishyam 3' is completely different and our film is also completely different. It's not like we have made a lot of changes; it's an entirely different story." The actor said the franchise's earlier film, 'Drishyam 2', had left the team wondering if there was anywhere further to go with the story. "I think that after 'Drishyam 2', we didn't know if this film would be made or not, because this isn't a film where you work out a script and make a sequel. It has twists and turns," he said. The actor said director Abhishek Pathak eventually came up with an idea that appealed to the team and then spent two-and-a-half years working on the screenplay with the writers. "He worked very hard and came out with a script. I think Abhishek and Aamil (Keeyan Khan) have done a brilliant job," he said.

Ajay also praised Pathak's growth as a filmmaker through his association with the franchise. "The way he's worked the script out, the way he's shaped up the film... As he said, he's grown on 'Drishyam'. You will see in this film that he's really grown on 'Drishyam'. And just on the writing part, the way he's executed the film, I think he's done a fabulous job."

Devgn said he would be particularly happy if Mohanlal and Jeethu Joseph, who collaborated on the original franchise, approve of the Hindi film. "I want Lal sir and Jeethu sir to see the film and if we get their approval that they love this, it'll make me very happy," he added. The third film picks up from where 'Drishyam 2' ended, with Vijay and his family facing renewed pressure as old secrets and unanswered questions threaten to resurface, according to the makers.

This time, Vijay encounters a formidable new adversary in Jaid-eep Ahlawat's SP Crime Branch Rajveer Singh Tomar, who takes charge of the seemingly impossible case and is determined to uncover the truth.

Asked whether he was sad to say goodbye to a popular franchise like 'Drishyam', Devgn said he is happy that they are ending the story on a good note. "I don't want to sound completely heartless, but whenever something gets over, in a sense, a project, then I'm the happiest person. People congratulate me when I start a project, but I feel that when it gets over and gets successfully over, then that's the time you should be the happiest person. Fingers crossed, if the film does well, then it will be good. But the journey has been great."

Ahlawat joined the franchise after Akshaye Khanna, who played IGP Tarun Ahlawat, the police officer leading the investigation against Vijay Salgaonkar in 'Drishyam 2', made an abrupt exit from the third part in January this year.

'Hope everybody likes my work'



Actress Aneet Padda will be seen in Jio Hotstar's series 'Hunkkaar: The Roar'

Aneet Padda said her upcoming series 'Hunkkaar: The Roar' goes beyond the specific story of a sexual harassment survivor to explore the universal experience of having one's personal choices and experiences subjected to public scrutiny.

In the 'JioHostar' show, Padda, who broke out with her role of Vaani from 2025's blockbuster 'Saiyaara', plays a 17-year-old girl who accuses a godman of sexual harassment.

"For me, what stuck out the most was the fact that as soon as somebody shares a personal experience out in public, it quickly becomes everybody's matter to an extent that the person sharing it ends up feeling like, 'Oh, maybe you're all right'. You end up questioning your own truth when you hear so much about it from other people," Padda said at the trailer launch of the show here.

She believes that the constant stream of opinions about how a person should act, speak or respond can overwhelm their own perspective. "There's an oversaturation of perspectives when people are like, 'Oh, but you should have done this' or 'she should be doing this' or 'behaving like this' or 'saying this or saying that'. So, I think that for me, that's the heart of 'Hunkkaar' because not only does it talk about this specific story, I feel like it also discusses the universal aspect of what we experience in our day-to-day as human beings," she added.

Padda said she is looking forward to audiences seeing the contrast between her roles in 'Hunkkaar' and 'Saiyaara'. "There's always a certain anxiety whenever



IN THE 'JIOHOSTAR' SHOW, SHE PLAYS A 17-YEAR-OLD GIRL WHO ACCUSES A GODMAN OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT

your work is coming out. I don't think it's because, 'Oh, now that I played a character like Vaani, what will they think about this?' It's just that I hope that everybody likes my work," she said.

"I also think as an actor, it's so interesting because Vaani is quite different from this character. So, I'm just really excited for everybody to see that contrast and I want to hear what everybody thinks about it," she added.

'Hunkkaar' features Padda as Meenu Rawat, a 17-year-old who accuses a revered cult leader, Sunil Chakosi, of sexual harassment. The accusation sets off an investigation led by Fatima Sana Shaikh's ACP Jasleen Singh Soni, while also becoming a larger battle involving power, influence and public perception.

Directed by Karan D Kapadia, Nitya Mehra and Heeraz Marfatia, the social investigative drama is created by Kapadia and Mehra.

Padda said she auditioned for the role when she was 17 and at the time, saw the story primarily as Meenu's coming-of-age journey.

DESPITE HER NEW LIFE...

Imran-Jemima's love story will continue

More than two decades after divorcing Imran Khan, Jemima Goldsmith married Irish Australian financier Cameron O'Reilly

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

At a time when her former husband has been languishing in a Pakistani jail for the past three years, Jemima Goldsmith has walked down the aisle again at the age of 52. More than two decades after divorcing Imran Khan, Jemima has married Irish Australian financier Cameron O'Reilly, 62, in a private ceremony. The marriage marks a new chapter in a life that has travelled a remarkable distance from the one she began as Imran's 21-year-old bride.

When Jemima married Imran in 1995, she was barely out of her teens and he was 42, a celebrated former Pakistan cricket captain with a reputation as an international playboy. She converted to Islam before the marriage, moved to Lahore, learned Urdu, started wearing traditional Pakistani shalwar

kameez and appeared in public with her head covered.

The daughter of billionaire financier Sir James Goldsmith wasn't aware of the potholes that lay before her. The age difference, cultural divide and her husband's plunge into the landmine of Pakistani politics meant that, instead of her husband, her every action would come under intense public scrutiny, especially her Jewish ancestry. Pakistani newspapers and TV channels saw a Zionist plot to weaken the country.

Given this atmosphere, it was inevitable that the marriage wouldn't last long. In June 2004, after nine years, they decided to part ways. The reason was very civil and restrained. Imran admitted that Jemima had tried her best to settle in Pakistan but that his political life had made it difficult for her to adapt. The decision was described as mutual. Jemima returned to Britain with their two sons, Sulaiman and Kasim.



Agneetha Fältskog of ABBA fame said after her divorce from Björn Ulvaeus, publicly, it was portrayed as a 'happy divorce'. Many years later, in a documentary, she revealed that there was no such thing as a 'happy divorce'. There is so much acrimony, pain and heartbreak behind every divorce, she added. Singing songs like 'The Winner Takes It All' and 'The Day Before

You Came' took a heavy toll on her and left her exhausted. Jemima's divorce must be one of the most remarkably civil celebrity separations of recent times. When celebrities part ways, dirty linen is washed in public, as we have seen in the Depp-

JEMIMA'S DIVORCE MUST BE ONE OF THE MOST REMARKABLY CIVIL CELEBRITY SEPARATIONS OF RECENT TIMES

Heard divorce saga.

Unlike many celebrities who claim they remain 'good friends' after divorce, the Imran-Jemima relationship continued despite Imran's two subsequent marriages and Jemima's romantic link-ups with Hugh Grant, Russell Brand and Peter Morgan.

Indeed, Imran continued to stay at the Goldsmith family home when he visited Britain. On her part, Jemima has supported Imran on social media.

She has repeatedly spoken about Imran's imprisonment and treatment in Pakistan. She has campaigned for his access to his sons and publicly raised concerns about his circumstances.

Some conservative religious leaders even questioned

why a divorced Imran continued to stay at Jemima's family home, insinuating about the nature of their relationship.

Jemima's concern for Imran and his family has gone far beyond social media. Before her death in 2004, Sita White, the mother of Imran's daughter Tyrian, named Jemima as one of Tyrian's guardians in her will. Tyrian was initially cared for by her aunt; it's reported that after Tyrian's aunt died, she moved into Jemima's London home. This is the remarkable story of two people's love and respect for one another despite so many differences.

They may have failed as husband and wife, but it didn't diminish their relationship, which has survived the gulf between London and Lahore. Both have continued their journey in different directions, yet even 22 years of separation haven't been able to separate them from one another in their hearts. They remain inseparable.